

Danmarks
Grundforskningsfond
Danish National
Research Foundation

ANNUAL REPORT

2024

Key figures

	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020
Grants and distributions					
Total number of grants at year-end	59	61	58	52	49
Annual distributions, million DKK	458.2	430.8	371.0	360.0	335.2
Return on investment					
Bonds and cash, million DKK	127.8	211.5	-484.0	-8.7	104.1
Equities, million DKK	377.2	338.6	-372.0	441.4	251.5
Total return, million DKK	505.0	550.1	-856.0	432.7	355.6
Administrative costs					
Administrative costs including depreciation, million DKK	13.5	13.6	12.8	12.8	12.3
Administrative costs compared to distributions, %	2.9	3.2	3.4	3.6	3.7
Administrative costs per grant, million DKK	0.2	0.2	0.3	0.3	0.3
Capital					
Net capital at year-end, million DKK	4,790.1	4,761.1	4,659.4	5,903.0	5,846.0

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Preface

13 new Centers of Excellence on the way

> *It is time to evaluate the efficacy of the Center of Excellence format, especially regarding criteria for excellence and the size of funding*

In the cycle of the Danish National Research Foundation (DNRF), 2024 was a special year. The DNRF opened 13 new Centers of Excellence. The success rate was 8% and the total funding was DKK 730 million over six years. The centers cover the entire academic spectrum and focus on research questions ranging from migraine and fertility to economics and Arctic research to quantum science and green materials.

The DNRF expects these centers to build highly ambitious and creative environments that churn out research, talent, and innovation at the forefront, for up to ten years and beyond.

The DNRF believes the centers are successful because the foundation carefully selects grantees and because the centers focus on research potential and are given optimal conditions for establishing trust, flexibility, and stability.

Last year also marked a year of transition as Professor Dorthe Dahl-Jensen replaced Professor Jens Kehlet Nørskov as chair of the foundation, while Professor Niels Mejlgaard replaced Professor Søren-Peter Olsen as CEO of the foundation.

With the successfully completed 12th round of Centers of Excellence, it is time to evaluate the efficacy of the Center of Excellence format, especially regarding criteria for excellence and the size of funding. In 2025 an external party will conduct an evaluation, providing the DNRF board with input for strategic considerations and ideas

for improvement before the announcement of the 13th call for Centers of Excellence.

The external evaluation will be important in guiding the process of enhancing the understanding of the mechanisms at play at Centers of Excellence that promote excellence and generate societal impact.

The past year the foundation has engaged in a dialogue with all Centers of Excellence about the way in which they promote creativity. Nine main recommendations from this dialogue were collected in the foundation's Annual Meeting Publication 2024. The DNRF is impressed with the grant holders' reflections, which gave new insights into the mechanics of Centers of Excellence, and the way in which a highly ambitious and creative *"spirit"* is nurtured, leading to excellence. Among the points that have inspired the board are accounts of the importance of the highly trusting and non-hierarchical environments that emerge in the Centers of Excellence.

Motivation and synergies thrive when researchers are not afraid to share ideas despite harsh competition and inter- and transdisciplinary collaborations, and when researchers are given the time and stability to mature, the result is highly novel ideas.

Professor Dorthe Dahl-Jensen, Chair of the board of the DNRF
Professor Søren-Peter Olesen, former CEO of the DNRF



"Motivation and synergies thrive when researchers are not afraid to share ideas despite harsh competition and inter- and transdisciplinary collaborations

DNRF highlights 2024

The following pages briefly report some of the significant developments from DNRF grant holders and the foundation itself in the past year.

- **DKK 730 million for 13 new Centers of Excellence**
- **The Pioneer Center for SMARTbiomed** *(Statistical and Computational Methods for Advanced Research to Transform Biomedicine)*
- **Five new DNRF Chairs**
- **New Chair of the DNRF**
- **A farewell to the CEO**
- **Publication** *Nine recommendations for the promotion of creativity in research*
- **Center Leader Retreat on excellence and legacy**
- **Promoting novelty in Danish research DNRF Annual Meeting 2024**
- **Young Academic Leaders retreat**
- **The DNRF Photo Competition 2024**

September 2024

DKK 730 million for 13 new Centers of Excellence

In September 2024, the board of the DNRF decided to offer funding for 13 new DNRF Centers of Excellence.

"*I would like to emphasize that there were really many qualified applicants, and I wish that we could accept even more, because there is plenty of talent in the Danish research community,*" said Professor Dorthe Dahl-Jensen, Chair of DNRF, in a press release.

Søren-Peter Olesen, who, at that time was CEO of the DNRF, was also very satisfied with the 13 applicants chosen. They fulfill the foundation's purpose of funding excellent basic research at the highest international level.

Søren-Peter Olesen said, "*The DNRF has always been very pleased that we have the opportunity to fund research in all areas, and it is incredibly positive that we have once again received applications that cover a very large part of the research spectrum this year.*"

Read the full press release



June 2024

The Pioneer Center for SMARTbiomed

(Statistical and Computational Methods for Advanced Research to Transform Biomedicine)

In June 2024, the last of four Pioneer Centers opened. With a DKK 250 M 13-year budget, the center, SMARTbiomed, focuses on collecting and analyzing large amounts of data from both Danish and international registers and biobanks. SMARTbiomed aims to learn more about, among other things, risk factors, relationships, patterns, treatment, and consequences.

The center is led by Professor Naomi Wray, University of Oxford and Aarhus University, who is internationally recognized for her research in psychiatric genetics.

Read more about the Pioneer Center initiative



During 2024

Five new DNRF Chairs

The DNRF board awarded five new DNRF Chairs, allowing the universities to support and boost the start-up research activities of potential or newly recruited outstanding tenured professors at Danish universities right from the beginning of their employment.

Read more about the new DNRF Chairs and the Chair program



August 2024

New Chair of the DNRF

Dorthe Dahl-Jensen has been a member of the foundation's board since January 2024 and was appointed to the chair of the DNRF by Christina Egelund, Minister for Higher Education and Science.

"With Dahl-Jensen as chair, the Danish National Research Foundation will have a world-class researcher who fully understands the nature and potential of research. She is, at the same time, nerdy, knows how to communicate, and can think strategically," said Egelund in the press release from the Ministry.

For decades, Dahl-Jensen has been at the forefront of research related to ice core drilling and Arctic Sea ice. As a glaciologist, she has helped to achieve groundbreaking insights into the climate of the past that can help us understand what the future holds.

Read more



Dorthe Dahl-Jensen

December 2024

A farewell to the CEO

At the end of 2024, Professor Søren-Peter Olesen stepped down from his position as CEO of the Danish National Research Foundation. Since his arrival at the DNRF in 2015, he has supervised the funding of more than forty Centers of Excellence and four Pioneer Centers. Furthermore, he has launched several new projects and initiatives in the secretariat.

In an interview with the DNRF, Olesen said: *"The concept is the same as when the foundation was established in 1991, but we are self-reflective and are constantly aware of whether we can do better. In its essence, research does not change, but the framework for conducting it is changing rapidly. We are working hard to adapt to this changing world and make adjustments to our instrument so we can hold the central role the foundation takes in Danish research. In recent years, the tight budgets at the universities have been a challenge, not only for the universities but also for the foundations. Internally, a lot has also happened at the DNRF in the form of major upgrades of, for example, data, law, communication, and thematic publications, where many of the topics related to the changing reality are addressed in collaboration with the researchers."*

He also mentioned the Pioneer Centers as an initiative he believes the DNRF can be proud of:

"In addition to establishing four world-class centers, we have created a forum for trust between one public and four large private foundations in Denmark that finance research. I believe that's unique, and we are very satisfied with the success of the Pioneer Center initiative."

"Søren-Peter Olesen has always been a strong and inspiring figure, focused on doing things the right way and staying true to his principles. His efforts have helped shape the foundation into what it is today, with a solid reputation and great funding opportunities. Having a basic research center is a real mark of quality," said DNRF Chair Dorthe Dahl-Jensen. She added that Olesen has left the organization in great shape, with plenty of potential moving forward.

Olesen's successor, Professor Niels Mejlgaard, took over the position of CEO in January 2025.



Søren-Peter Olesen. ©DNRF

August 2024

Nine recommendations for the promotion of creativity in research

At the DNRF, we believe it is important to discuss the conditions for creativity in research and to shed light on what, based on experience, promotes creativity. This should not be overlooked in light of the fact that studies indicate that research breakthroughs on a global scale are becoming rarer in relation to how much is invested in research and that Danish research is losing altitude.

Against this background, the foundation published an inspirational catalog, The Pursuit of Novelty, which comes with nine recommendations for people who want to stimulate a creative research environment. The recommendations are created based on the discussions and considerations that our Centers of Excellence have presented at follow-up meetings with the DNRF, where we have talked to the researchers about how they work on a daily basis to actively stimulate a creative research process.

The Pursuit of Novelty was also a source of inspiration for a thematic debate on the creative power of research in the online media Science Report, which included an interview with former DNRF CEO Søren-Peter Olesen. We also commissioned a conceptual clarification on the concept of creativity, carried out by the Danish Centre for Studies in Research and Research Policy, Aarhus University.



May 2024

Center Leader Retreat on excellence and legacy

Heads of DNRF Centers of Excellence and Pioneer Centers gather once a year to share experiences and discuss topics of importance for the successful operation of the centers. In 2024, these leaders discussed and exchanged experiences about the optimal conditions for excellence in research and in talent development. They also discussed how to ensure a good transition when center funding runs out, which is of consequence to maintaining the capacity and value production beyond the center's lifetime. The stage for these discussions was set by Lise Degn and Emil Alnor, Aarhus University, and co-authors of a DNRF-commissioned report on the legacy from Centers of Excellence between 1993 and 2005.



September 2024

DNRF Annual Meeting 2024

Promoting novelty in Danish research

At the DNRF 2024 Annual Meeting, center leaders presented their experience and views on different aspects of the promotion of creativity in research: For instance, the importance of stability, critical mass, and freedom in research, and of mixing disciplines and nurturing talent. Main players in the Danish research landscape subsequently debated these concepts.



Former Minister Bertel Haarder spoke about the DNRF's background and the foundation's birth at the annual meeting, 2024.



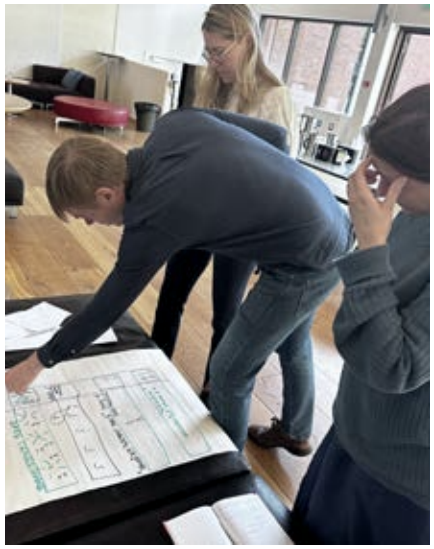
There was a lively debate and many interesting questions and input at the DNRF's annual meeting 2024, where the participants debated the creative research process.

September 2024

Young Academic Leaders retreat

For the third time, the foundation's grant holders were given the opportunity to send talented young leaders to the DNRF's Young Academic Leaders retreat. Here, the participants gained insight into how to forge a path toward a leadership role in research and had the opportunity to share experiences and challenges in relation to being in the middle of a research career.











September 2024

The DNRF Photo Competition 2024

For the seventh year in a row, the foundation launched a photo competition based on the potential of photography as a way to document and communicate about research.

The three judges, Ken Arnold, Andreas Roepstorff, and Charlotte Schwartz, announced the following three winners of the 2024 competition:

1st Prize: Epiphany, Amazon
Photo: Christian Vium, Associate Professor of Anthropology, Aarhus University

2nd Prize: Six points on a blackboard
Photo: Nathalie Wahl, DNRF Center GeoTop, University of Copenhagen

3rd Prize: The digestive system of dairy cows
Photo: Giulio Giagnoni, Department of Animal and Veterinary Sciences, Aarhus University

Read more about the three winners and the 2024 Photo Competition



Epiphany, Amazon. The winner of the DNRF Photo Competition 2024. Photo: Christian Vium, Associate Professor of Anthropology, Aarhus University.



Six points on a blackboard. The winner of the second prize in the DNRF Photo Competition 2024. Photo: Nathalie Wahl, DNRF Center GeoTop, University of Copenhagen.



The digestive system of dairy cows. The winner of the third prize in the DNRF Photo Competition 2024. Photo: Giulio Giagnoni, Department of Animal and Veterinary Sciences

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New grants 2024

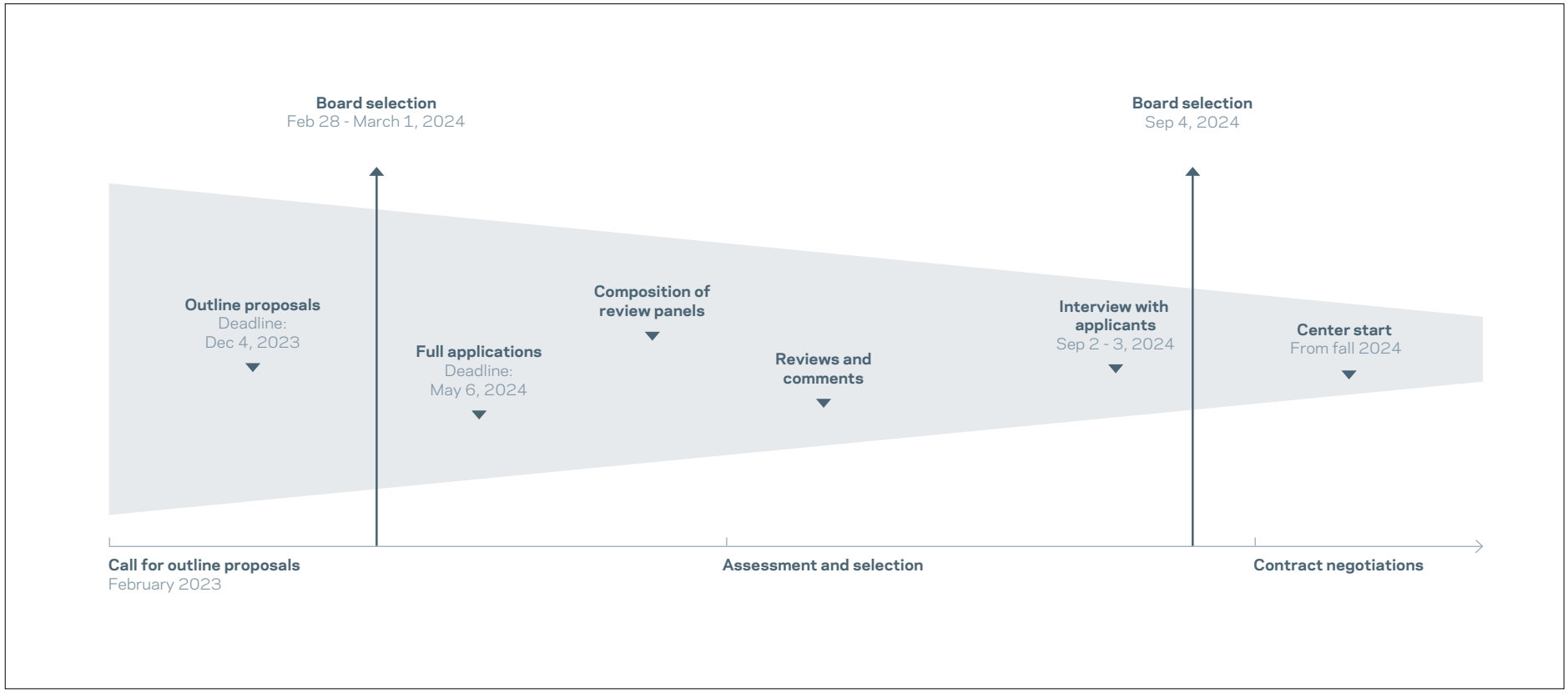
- **The 12th application round for Centers of Excellence - statistics and process**
- **Meet the 13 new Centers of Excellence**
- **The Pioneer Center Initiative**
- **Meet the new DNRF Chairs**



The 12th application round for Centers of Excellence - statistics and process

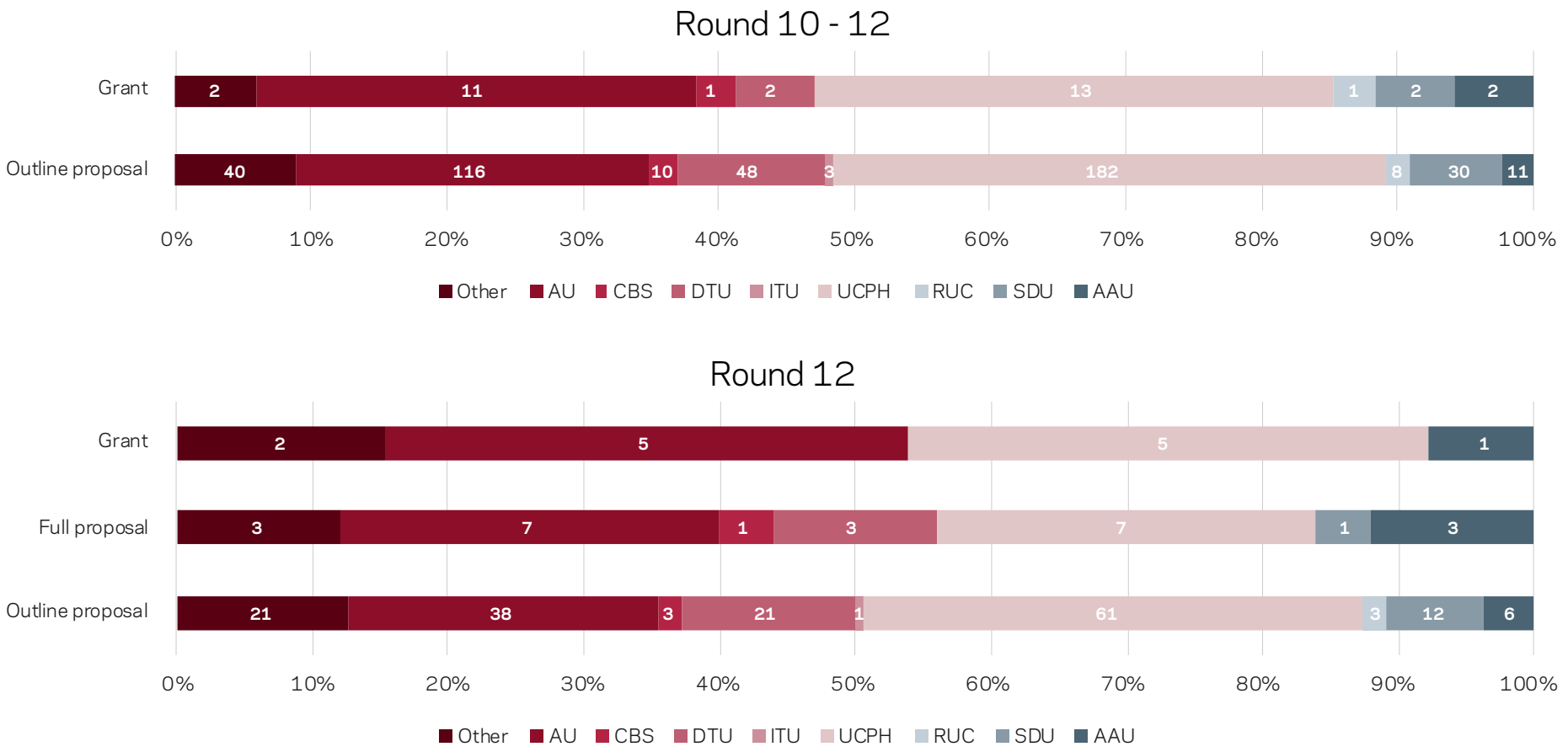
APPLICATION PROCESS

The DNRF received 166 outline proposals by the deadline of December 4, 2023. Of those 166 applicants, 25 were selected to submit a full proposal by May 6, 2024. At its meeting in September 2024, the board spent two days interviewing each of the 25 applicants. On the third day, the board made the final funding decisions and decided that the DNRF would create 13 new Centers of Excellence.



Outline proposals, full applications and grants distributed on host institutions

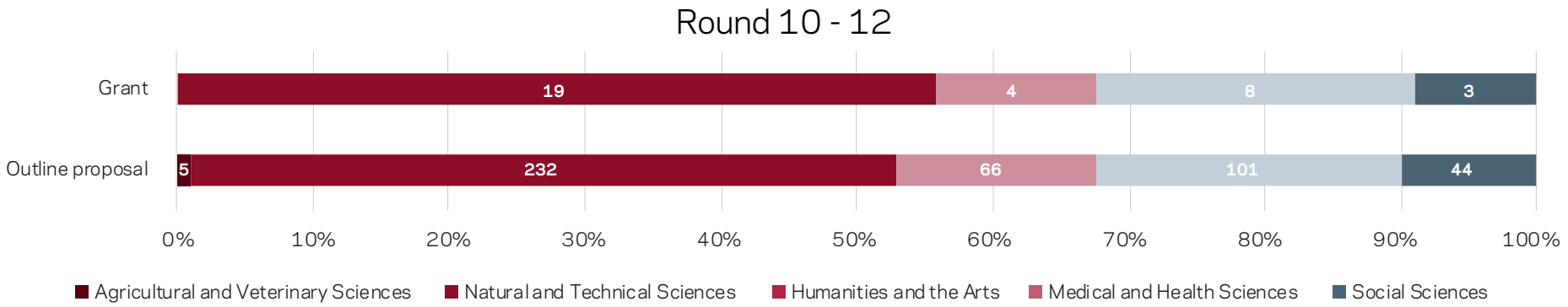
The figure shows the centers' main host institution. However, several centers have nodes at other institutions. The foundation always encourages the best researchers to establish the strongest possible research environments at or across Danish research institutions. The success rate for individual host institutions varies from round to round. An average for the last three rounds, round 10 - 12, can be seen below for comparison.

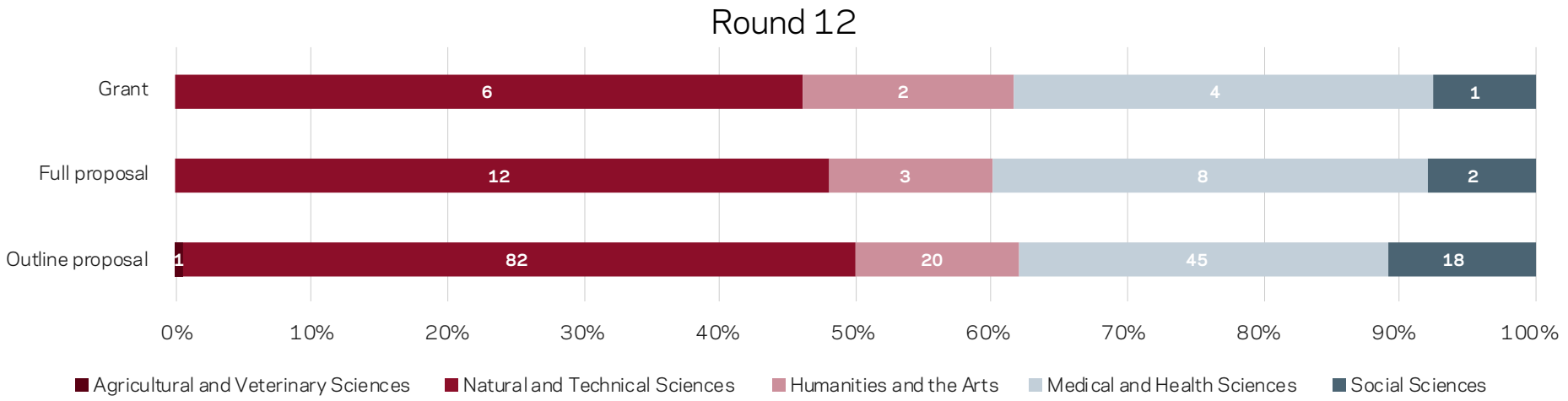


Outline proposals, full applications and grants distributed on fields of research

The division of fields of research is based on the centers' primary field of research, however it is somewhat artificial, since approximately half the centers are interdisciplinary across main fields.

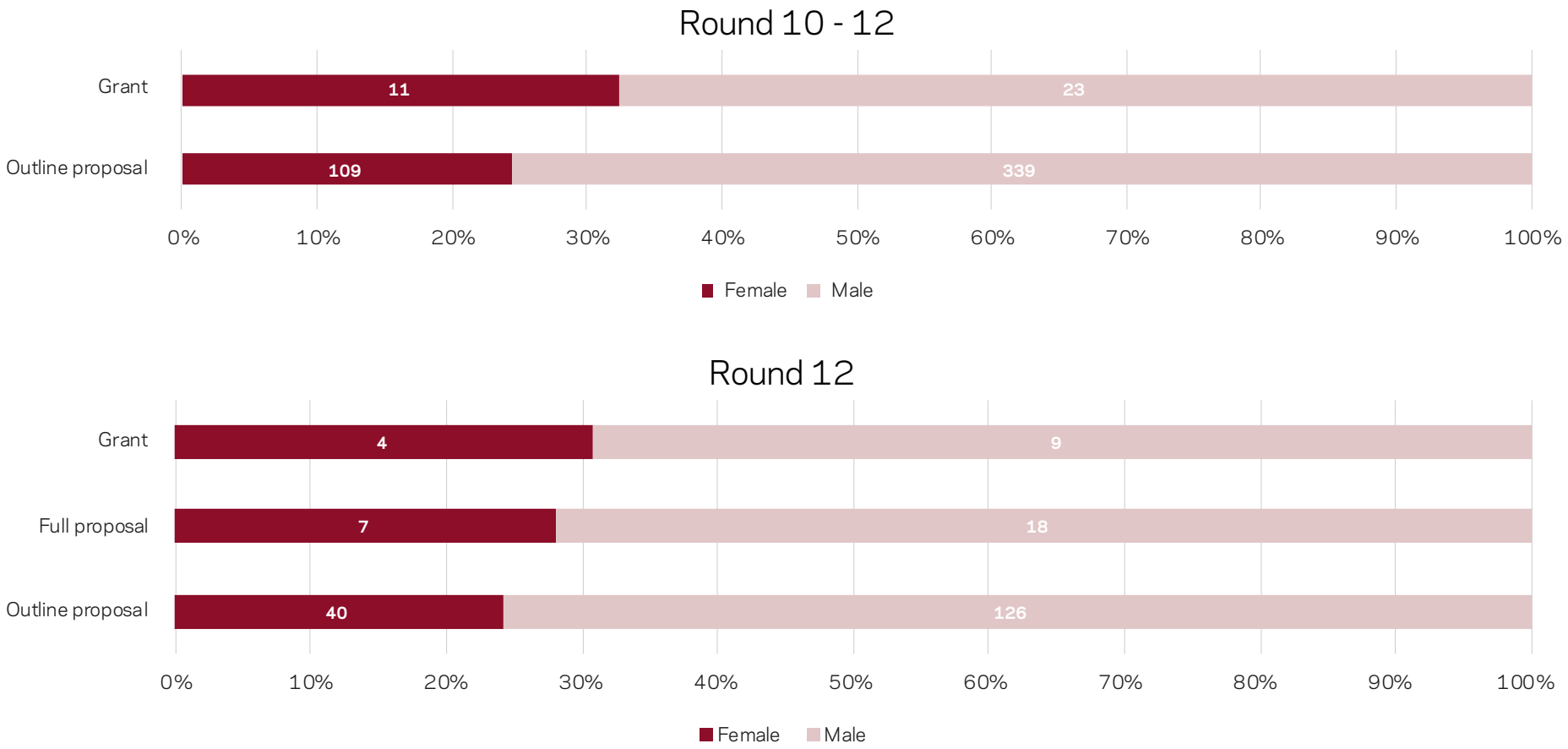
Counting interdisciplinarity within the main fields, almost all centers have an interdisciplinary research portfolio. The success rate for individual fields varies from round to round. An average for the last three rounds, round 10 - 12, can be seen below for comparison.





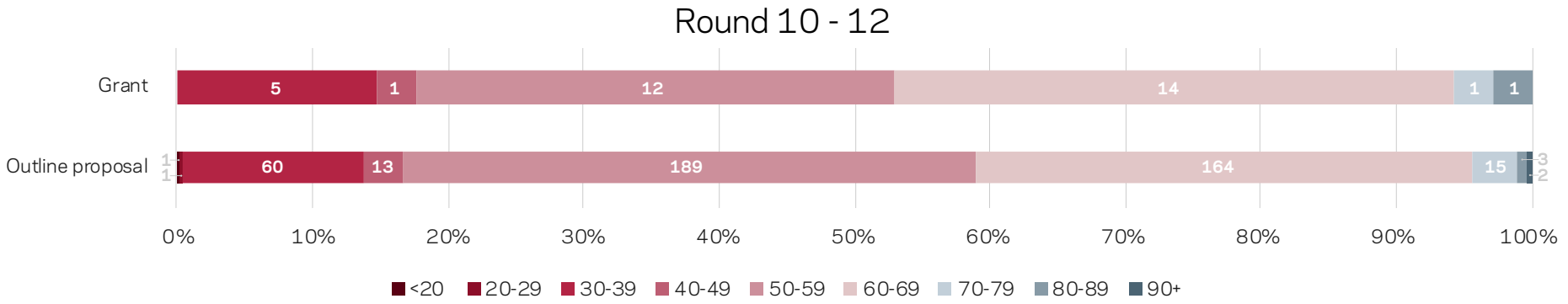
Gender distribution for outline proposals, full applications and grants

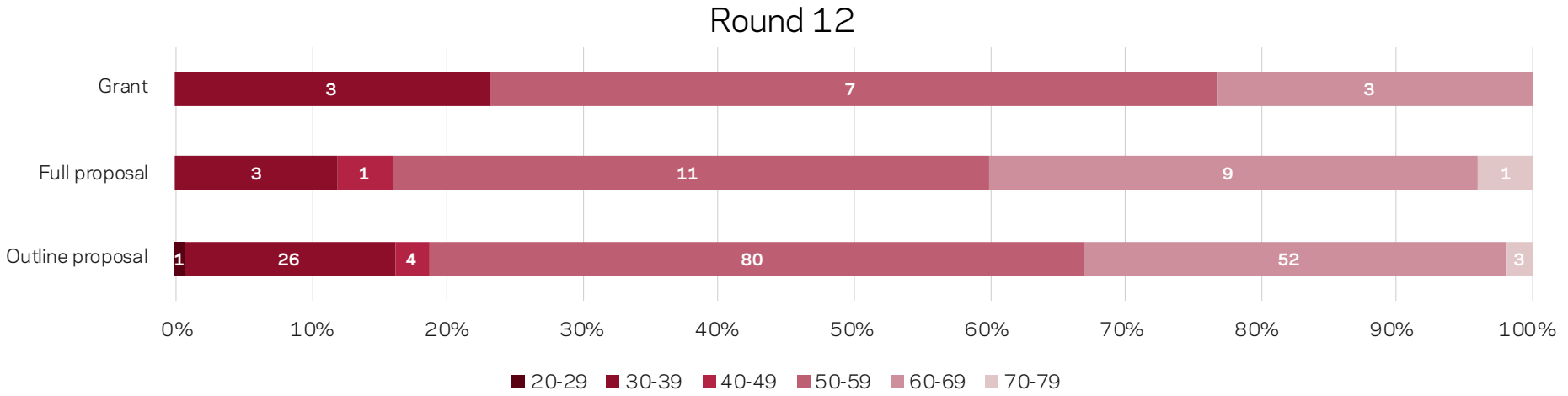
The Danish National Research Foundation monitors the ratio of women to men at centers and encourages the centers to aim for gender balance among the staff.



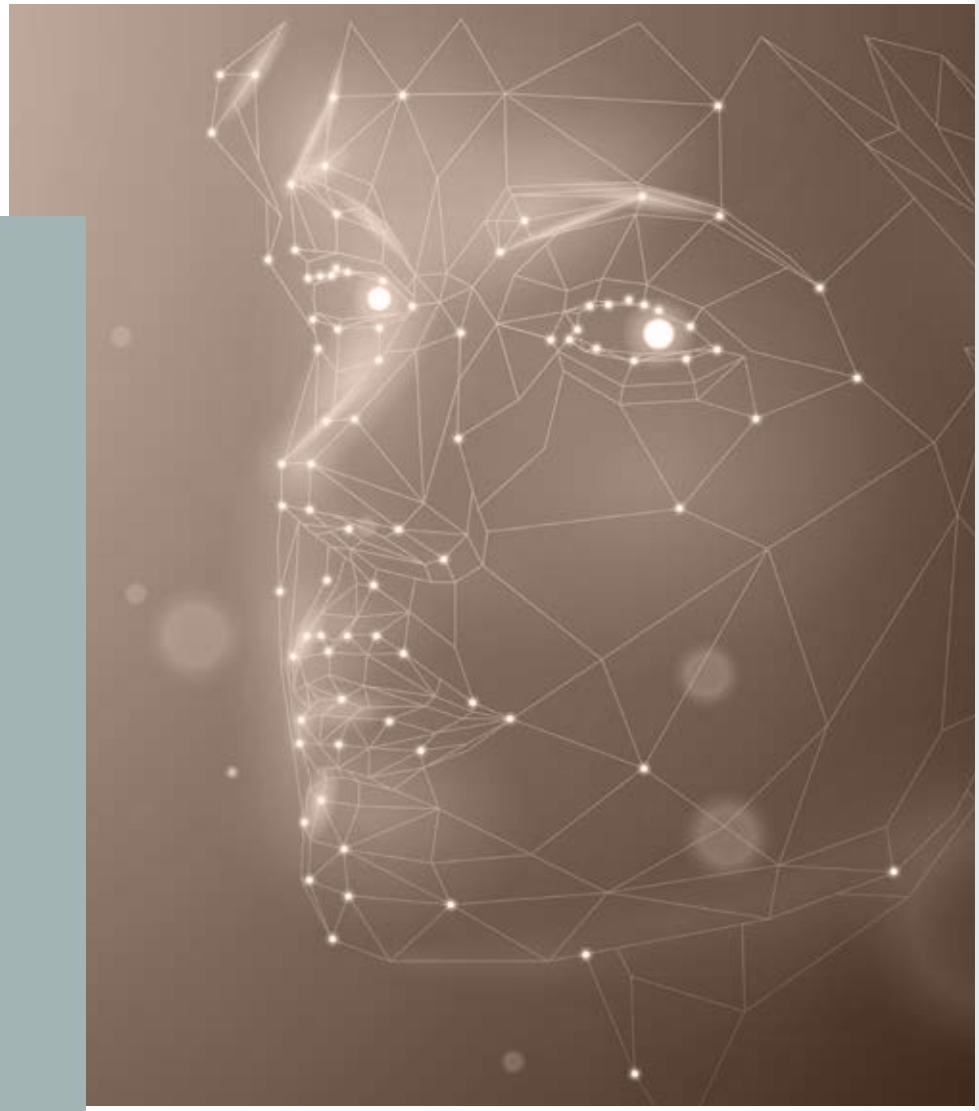
Distribution of applied amount for outline proposals, full applications and grants

There is no fixed formula for creating a CoE. The centers may differ in size and mode of organization, depending on their subject and scope. Centers of Excellence can consist of one or more research groups that work together in an ambitious and visionary way to solve complex research questions. Some centers become rather large during the grant period, employing more than 60 people divided into several research teams, while others have fewer than 15 members. The important thing is that the center members share a common idea or vision and have a well-defined framework for cooperation, so that the sum of the center creates synergy in bringing together complementary competencies in a way that surpasses what the individual elements could achieve. The applied amounts are divided and grouped in millions of DKK in graphs below.





Meet the 13 new DNRF Centers of Excellence



The Center of Excellence (CoE) program is the DNRF's primary funding mechanism and the foundation's flagship. A center grant is large and flexible, and a center may have a lifetime of up to 10 years. Only top researchers with the most ambitious ideas will be awarded a CoE through fierce competition involving a two-stage application process.

The objective of the CoE program is to strengthen Danish research by providing the best possible working conditions and organizational set-up for selected top researchers. It is the DNRF's clear strategy to focus on supremely talented individuals and provide them with sufficient funds, long-term funding horizons, and autonomy. The Centers of Excellence may be established within or across all fields of research.

Note: Contract negotiations with the new centers are currently ongoing.

Aarhus Center for Econometrics – **ACE**



ACE will pioneer the development of a new generation of modern and robust econometrics. These new econometric methods are important, for example, for the advanced models and data used in modern empirical studies. The aim is that the research will transform the use of data and statistical methods in economics and other behavioral sciences and that the robust methods will become standard practice. This breakthrough will lead to more reliable and correct inference in economics and other empirical fields. The impact extends beyond academia to, for example, improved policy analysis and evaluation.



Center leader: Morten Ø. Nielsen, Professor

Host institution: Aarhus University

Grant: DKK 36 million

▲ **Photo by** Lars Kruse/AU Foto

Center for Discoveries in Migraine - **CDM**



The Center for Discoveries in Migraine seeks to reveal the mechanisms that trigger and end migraine attacks through basic research. One goal is to develop new disease-specific treatments within the next 10 years. The center, which aims to create a world-leading research environment, collaborates with top researchers from Harvard University (USA), Leiden University (Netherlands), and the University of Copenhagen. It operates as part of the Department of Neurology at Rigshospitalet.



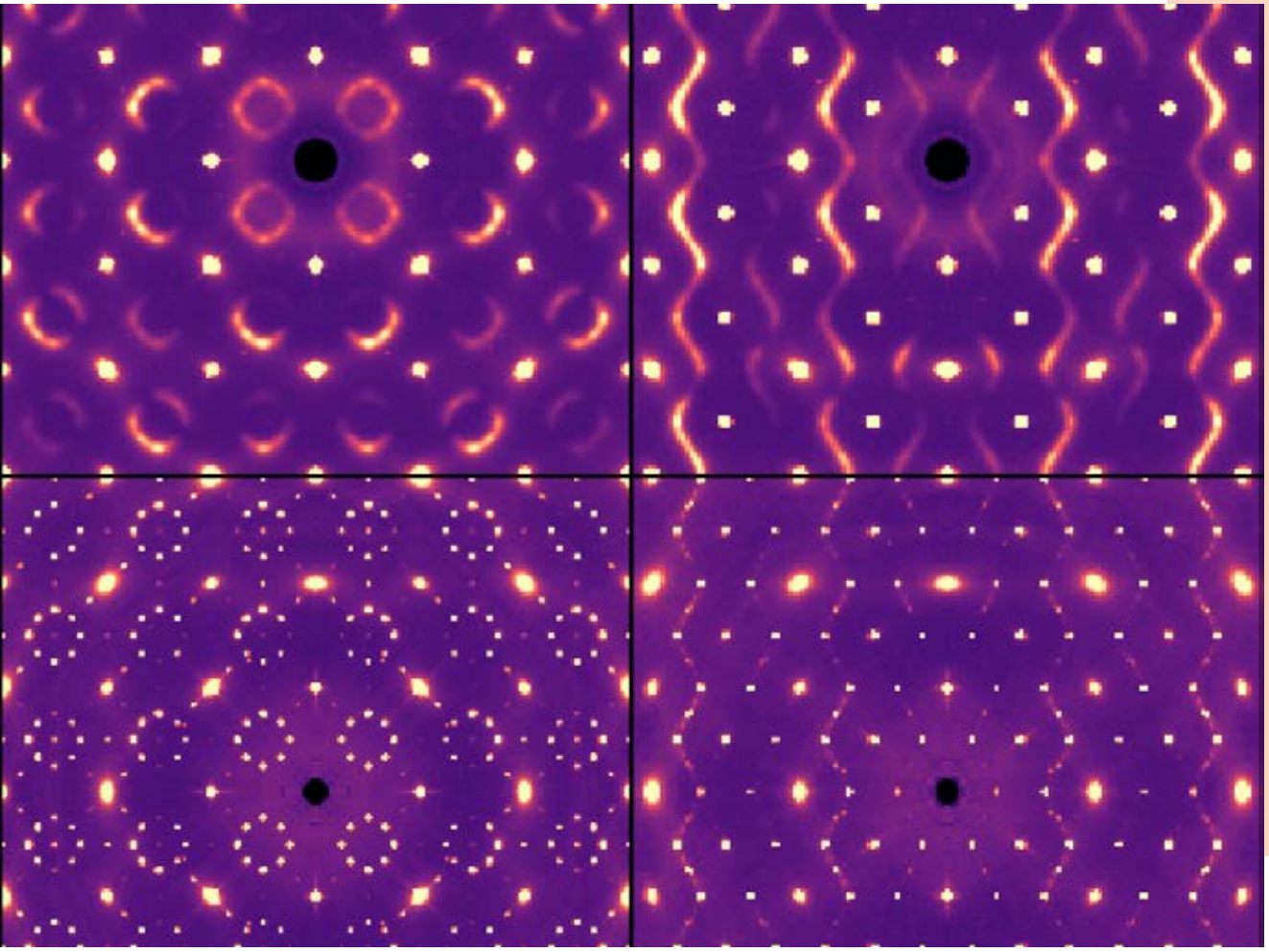
Center leader: Messoud Ashina, Professor

Host institution: Rigshospitalet

Grant: DKK 60 million

▲ **Photo by** Rigshospitalet
◀ **Photo by** Rigshospitalet

Center for Sustainable Energy Materials – **CenseMat**



The Center for Sustainable Energy Materials (CenseMat) aims to develop new energy materials based on abundant and sustainable resources. The center focuses on understanding and controlling atomic disorder in materials to enhance their ability to convert energy efficiently. By combining expertise across various energy materials, CenseMat seeks to create innovative solutions that support the green transition and reduce dependence on scarce resources.



Center leader: Dorthe Bomholdt Ravnsbæk, Professor

Host institution: Aarhus University

Grant: DKK 60 million

▲ **Photo by** Lars Svankjær, Videnskabernes Selskab

Center for Fertility and Inheritance – **CFI**



Fertility and inheritance are fundamental processes that affect human health. Five percent of children are born with a genetic predisposition to more than 9,000 rare disorders, and the majority of these disorders occur when parents pass on their DNA to their child. This only represents the tip of the iceberg, since 30% of human eggs contain too few or too many chromosomes and more than 50% of embryos are lost after fertilization. The CFI will explore how our DNA is passed on to our children, the impact on fertility, and whether the changes in DNA and its regulation are unique to our species or also occur in non-human primates.



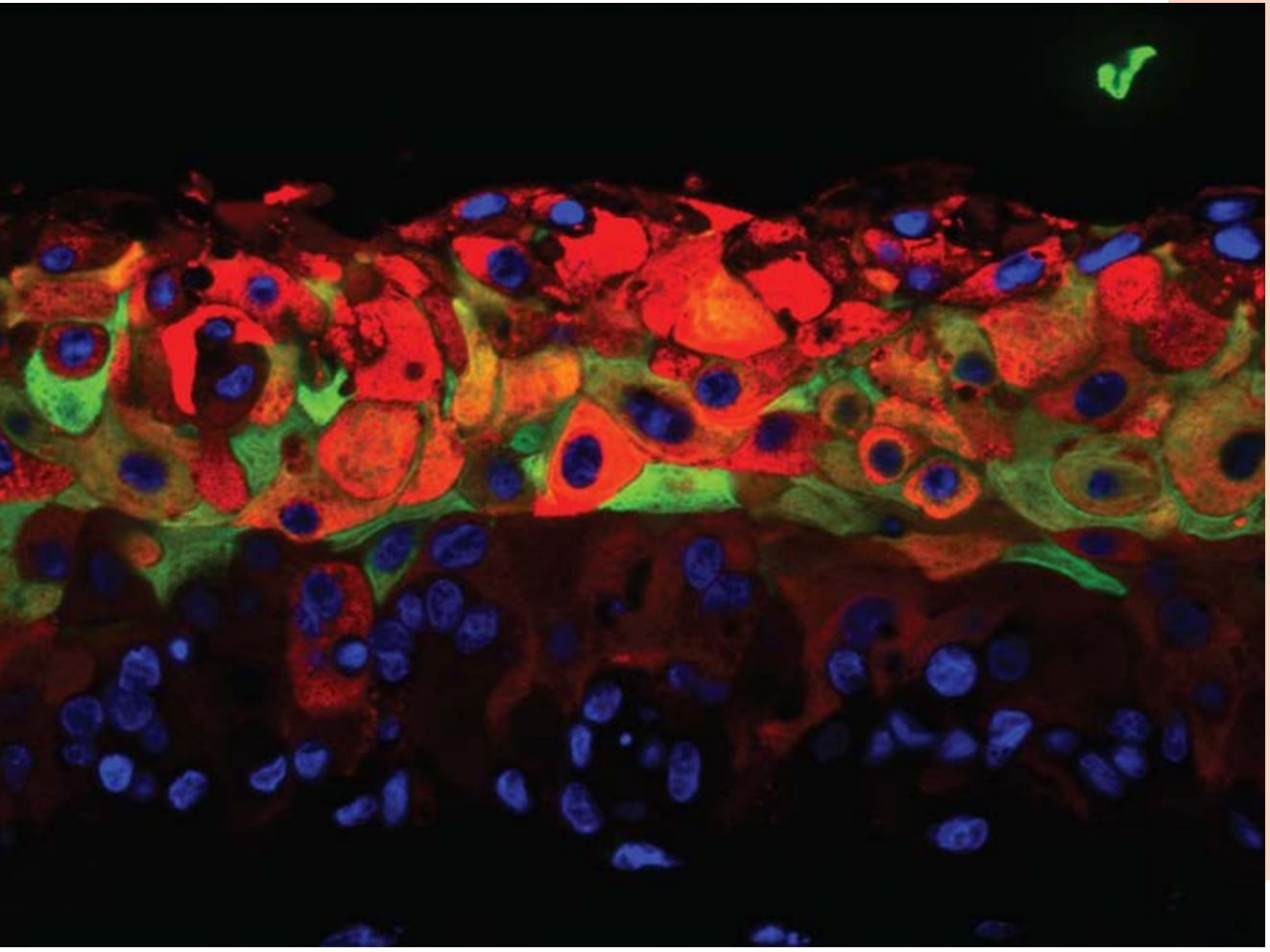
Center leader: Eva Hoffmann, Professor

Host institution: University of Copenhagen

Grant: DKK 70 million

▲ **Photo by** KU
◀ **Photo by** Antonio Capalbo

Center for Glycocalyx Research – **CGR**



All communication between cells involves the cell surface. The Center for Glycocalyx Research studies how our cell surface molecules mediate communication between cells and their environment. It focuses on how inflammation and degenerative disorders affect the configurations and network of cell surface proteins, altering cellular signaling. The center's aim is to understand these complex changes and how the resulting disease-specific patterns can be used for targeted therapies.



Center leader: Hans Wandall, Professor

Host institution: University of Copenhagen

Grant: DKK 60 million

▲ **Photo by** KU
◀ **Photo by** Sally Dabelsteen, KU

Center for Ice-Free Arctic Research – **CIFAR**



The Center for Ice-free Arctic Research (CIFAR) aims to investigate the consequences of melting ice and increased freshwater influx in the Arctic. The center focuses on how these changes affect the ocean's physical and chemical properties, marine ecosystems, and global ocean currents. By combining field data, satellite observations, and models, CIFAR seeks to provide a comprehensive overview of future changes in the Arctic Ocean and their impact on climate.



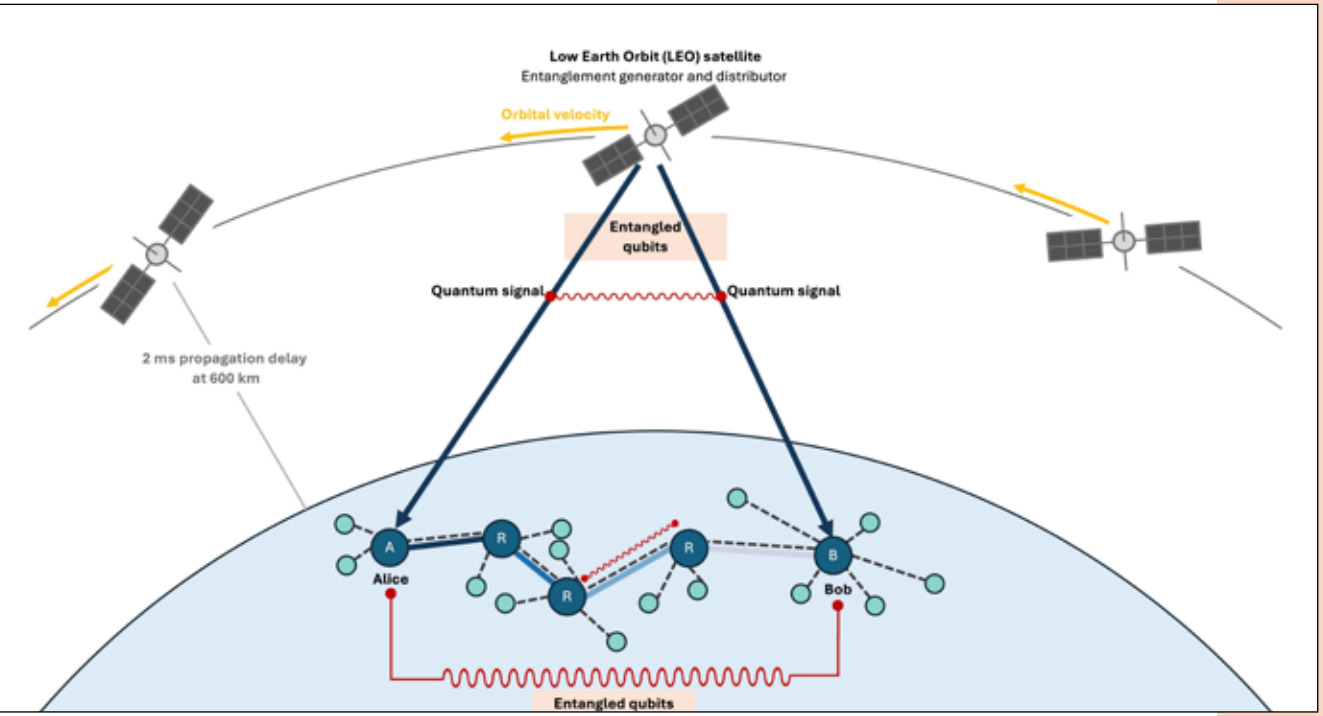
Center leader: Søren Rysgaard, Professor

Host institution: Aarhus University

Grant: DKK 60 million

▲ **Photo by** Peter Bondo Christensen AU
◀ **Photo by** University of Manitoba

Center for Classical Communication in the Quantum Era – **CLASSIQUE**

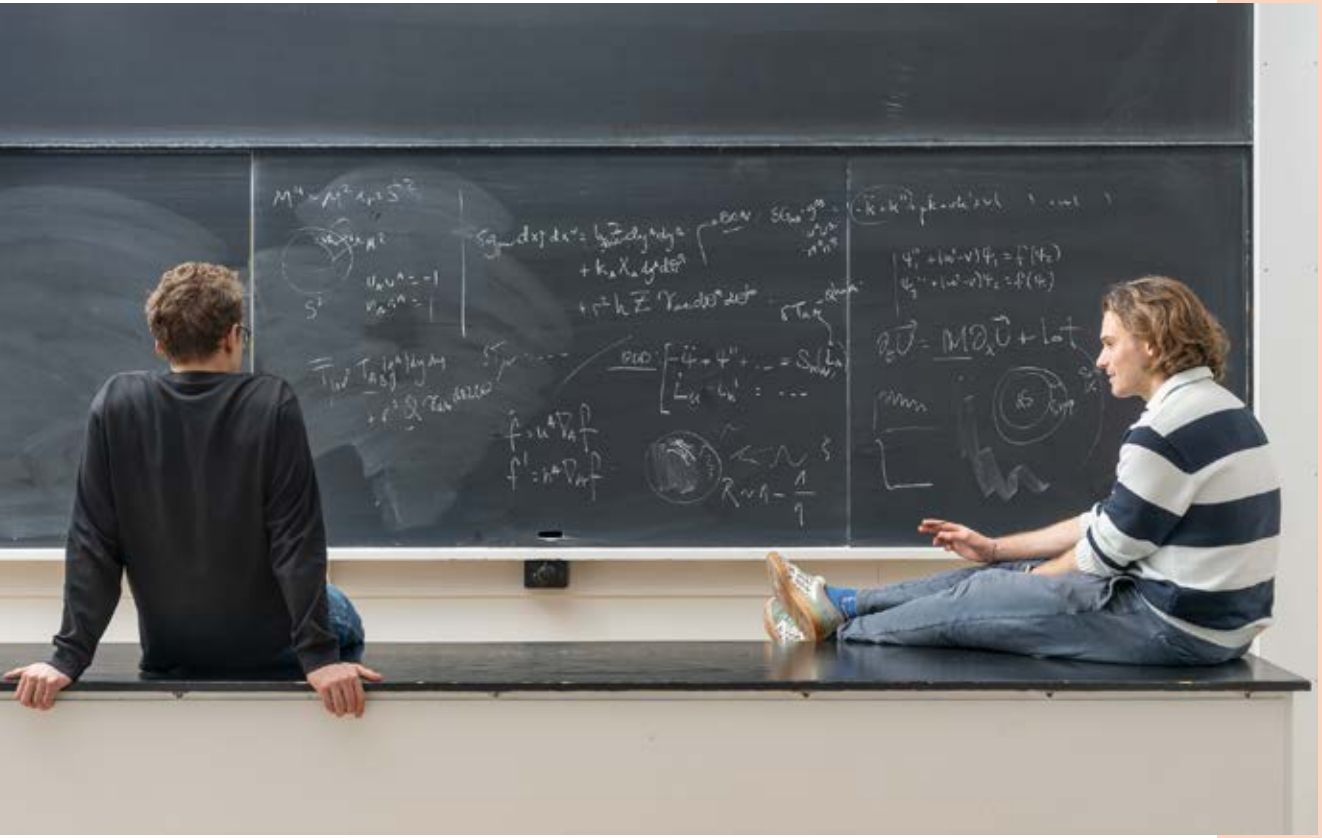


Typical operations in distributed quantum systems such as teleportation and quantum key distribution are based on entanglement, which deteriorates over time and must be used shortly after its creation. This behavior imposes new timing requirements for classical communication systems, which are needed to support quantum applications. CLASSIQUE focuses on this classical/quantum overlap, striving for results that ensure that the classical networks of the future will support the needs of quantum systems while fulfilling the real-time requirements of classical digital systems.



Center leader: Petar Popovski, Professor
Host institution: Aalborg University
Grant: DKK 60 million

The Center of Gravity – **CoG**



The Center of Gravity (CoG) will bring together cutting-edge research on observations of black holes and on the formal theory and quantum aspects of gravity, completing the visions of Bohr and Einstein for gravitational interaction. The research endeavor will span from data analysis to theoretical disciplines within astrophysics and high-energy physics, driving gravitational wave physics to an exciting future. The center will capitalize on the remarkable talent at the Niels Bohr Institute, to promote synergies linking fundamental physics with observations.



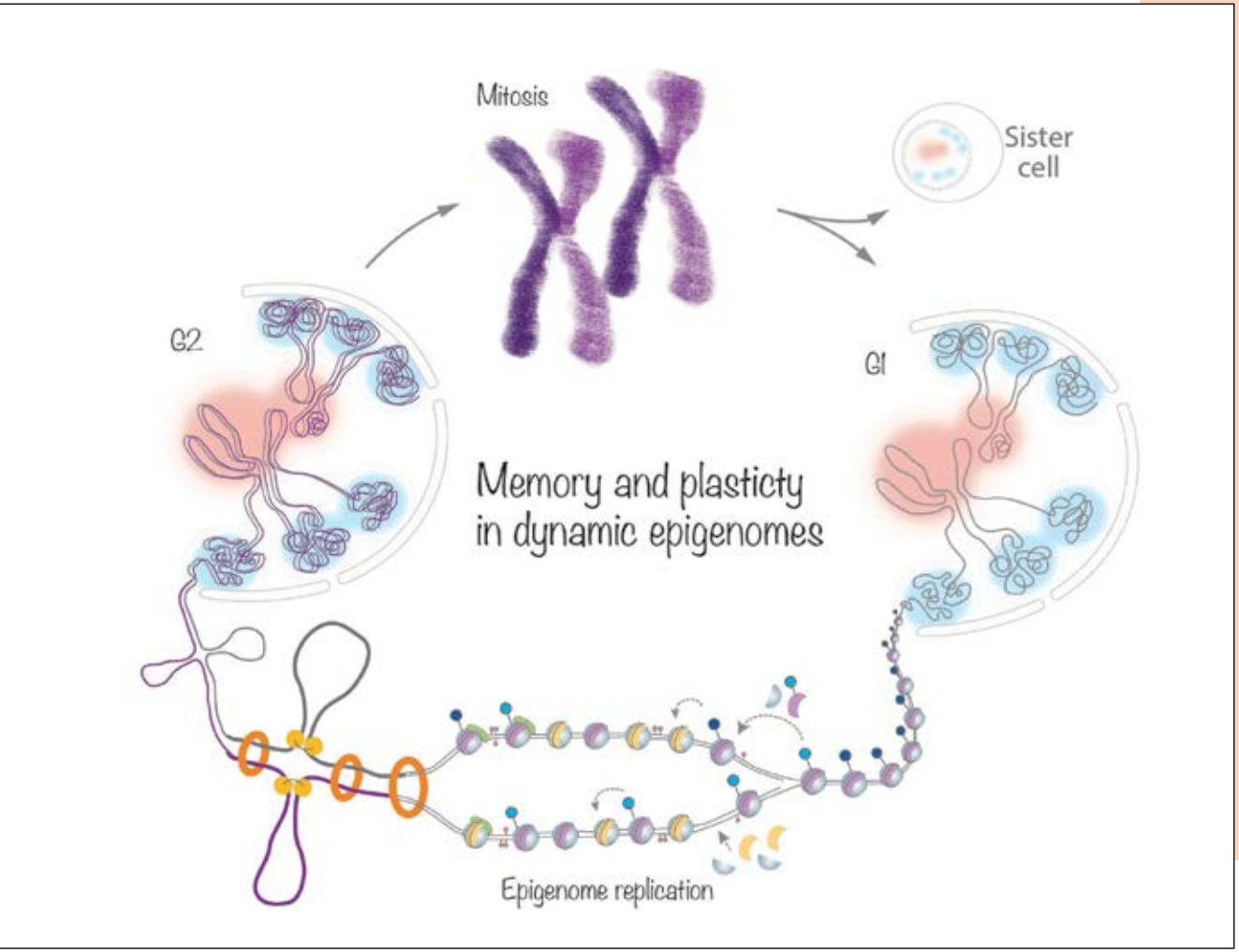
Center leader: Vitor Cardoso, Professor

Host institution: University of Copenhagen

Grant: DKK 60 million

▲ **Photo by** Ana Carvalho
◀ **Photo by** Sjoerd Knibbeler

Center for Epigenetic Cell Memory – **EpiC**

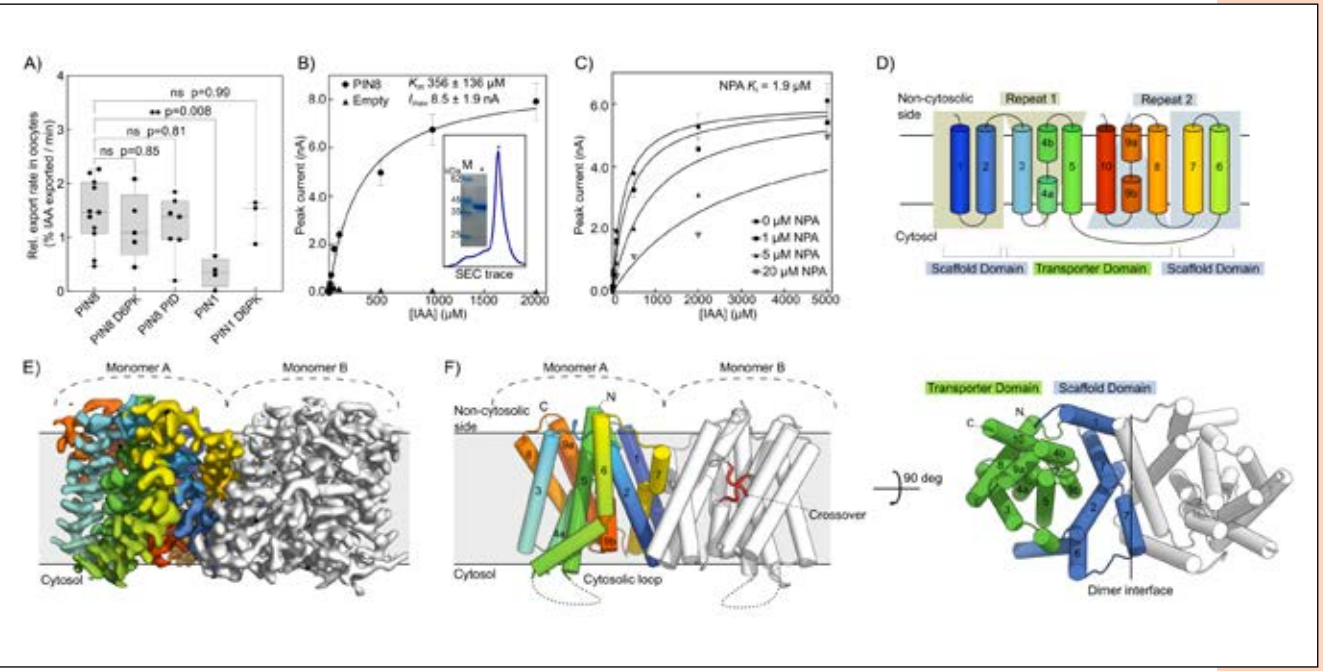


The epigenome is the fabric of eukaryotic life, sculpting the genome and its output in each of our cells. It enables cells to acquire specialized functions and remember their identity through multiple cell divisions, which critically underpin human development and health. EpiC's overarching goal is to elucidate how epigenomes are inherited and how cell proliferation influences cell fate. We will use advanced genomics and genetic screening to explore how molecular circuits and physical organization enable dynamic epigenomes to store information and provide lifelong memory.



Center leader: Anja Groth, Professor
Host institution: Danish Cancer Society
Grant: DKK 67 million

Center for Active Transport of Plant Hormones – **Plant-PATH**



The Center for Active Transport of Plant Hormones (Plant-PATH) aims to revolutionize the understanding of how plants adapt to environmental changes. By investigating the transport of plant hormones, the center seeks to develop crops capable of withstanding climate change, ensuring future food production. Plant-PATH brings together experts in plant physiology, qualitative modeling, and biophysics to comprehend and control the role of hormones in plant growth and environmental response.



Center leader: Bjørn Panyella Pedersen, Professor

Host institution: Aarhus University

Grant: DKK 60 million

Center for Contemporary Cultures of Text – **TEXT**



Center for Contemporary Cultures of Text (TEXT) at Aarhus University seeks to investigate how artificial intelligence is changing our text culture and the opportunities and dangers we need to be mindful of. This is important because text culture is a critical infrastructure that affects how we access information and process knowledge. Among the goals is to develop tools, through interdisciplinary collaboration, to minimize the risks posed by artificial intelligence and instead steer toward its potential opportunities.



Center leader: Mads Rosendahl Thomsen, Professor

Host institution: Aarhus University

Grant: DKK 39 million

▲ **Photo by** Liv Lindhardt Rohde Larsen, AU

Changing Urban and Rural Lives – **TRANSITION**



TRANSITION, the Center for Changing Urban and Rural Lives, studies how the transition from rural to urban-centric societies shaped people's lived experiences throughout the 20th century. The center is an interdisciplinary collaboration between the University of Copenhagen and the National Museum of Denmark, where researchers in sociolinguistics, literature, and history work together to uncover how the rural-to-urban transition has contributed to the formation of collective ideas, language, and policies in a Nordic context. The center will leverage and combine unique cultural-historical collections from both institutions, including the Dialect Archive at the Center for Dialect Research and the National Museum's ethnological collections.



Center leader: Pia Quist, Professor

Host institution: University of Copenhagen

Grant: DKK 40 million

▲ **Photo by** Peter Sørensen
◀ **Photo by** Michael Stoltze

Center for Remote Sensing and Deep Learning of Global Tree Resources – **TreeSense**



TreeSense aims to revolutionize global tree monitoring using advanced nano-satellite technology and next-generation deep learning (DL) methods within AI. This will enable detailed assessment of global tree dynamics. We focus on the effect of global warming on trees as well as the extent and dynamics of anthropogenic forest disturbance and degradation. The center will uncover the potential for tree-related production systems and human livelihoods as means of climate mitigation actions and aim to improve our understanding of the role of woody resources for sustainable food systems.



Center leader: Rasmus Fensholt, Professor

Host institution: University of Copenhagen

Grant: DKK 60 million

◀ **Photo by** ESA/ATG medialab

The Pioneer Center initiative

The establishment of the Pioneer Centers is an ambitious national undertaking initiated by the Ministry of Higher Education and Science and developed in close cooperation between the Ministry, the Danish National Research Foundation, the Carlsberg Foundation, the Lundbeck Foundation, the Novo Nordisk Foundation, the Villum Foundation, and the universities in Denmark.

Read more about the Pioneer Center initiative here.



The Pioneer Center for ***SMARTbiomed***

(Statistical and Computational Methods for Advanced Research to Transform Biomedicine)

SMARTbiomed strives to become a significant international partner for data-driven medical research.

The center has three main objectives:

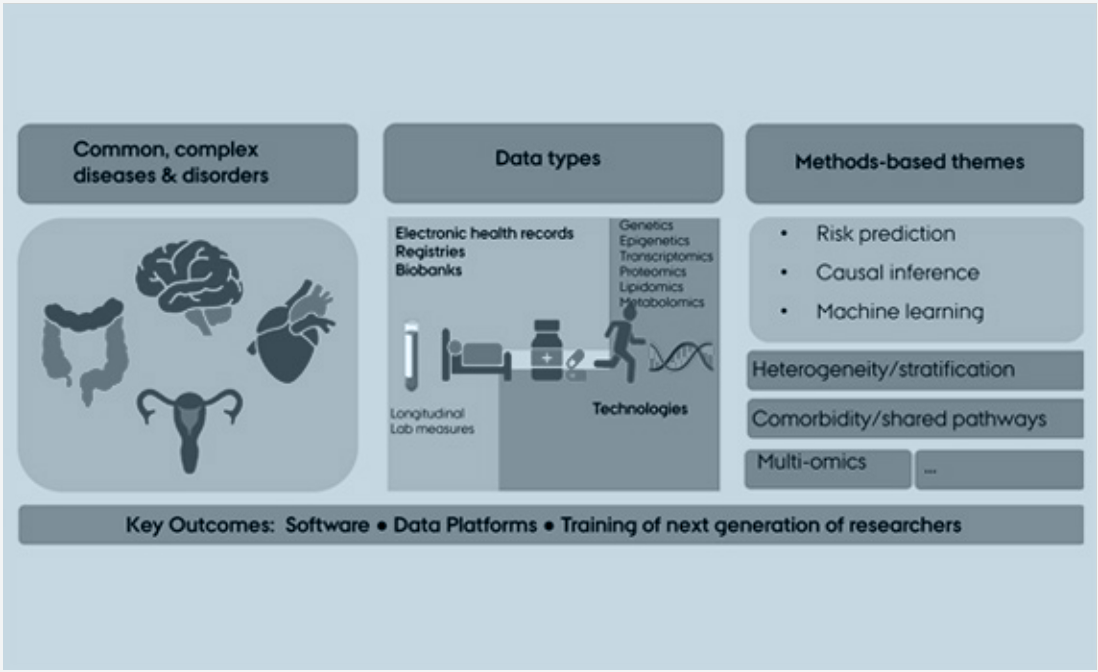
- To bring together multidisciplinary research teams to develop new methods for analyzing biomedical data.
- To develop data platforms and software for biomedical research that are based on real medical issues and that are easily applicable.
- To establish a leading international learning and career environment in health data research.

By focusing on collecting and analyzing large amounts of data from both Danish and international registers and biobanks, SMARTbiomed aims to learn more about, among other things, risk factors, relationships, patterns, treatment, and consequences.

Professor Naomi Wray, University of Oxford, who is internationally recognized for her research in psychiatric genetics, will be head of the new center. Professor Wray will also take up a position at Aarhus University. The Pioneer Center is anchored at Aarhus University, with hub sites at Aarhus, the University of Copenhagen, and the University of Oxford.



Center leader: Professor Naomi Wray
Host institution: Aarhus University
Grant: DKK 250 million (DKK 80 million from DNRF)
Web: smartbiomed.dk



Meet the new DNRF Chairs

With the overall purpose of strengthening and enriching Danish research communities, the aim of the DNRF Chair grant is to motivate and support Danish universities to attract and recruit particular outstanding researchers from abroad, including Danes wishing to return from an international position.

The five-year period for DNRF Chair initiative expired at the end of 2024. There will not be a new call for DNRF Chairs.



Read more.

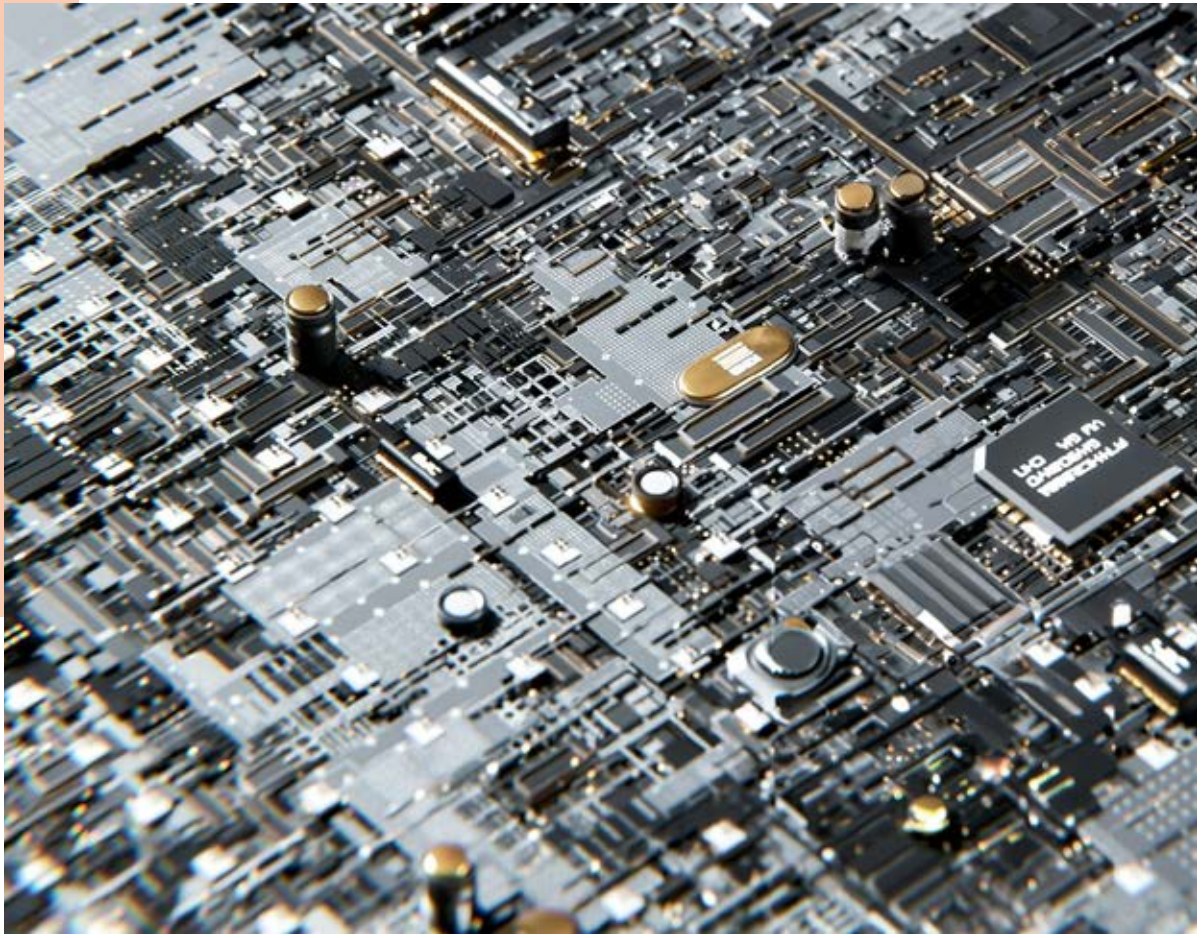


DNRF Chair:
Amir Yehudayoff

Period:
July 2024 – June 2027

Host institution:
University of Copenhagen

Machine learning (ML) and artificial intelligence (AI) have an amazing impact on our world. They bring promises but also dangers. How do they work? Can we trust them? As in many scientific endeavors, a solid mathematical foundation is crucial for finding answers. The research aims to significantly contribute to the mathematical foundations of ML.



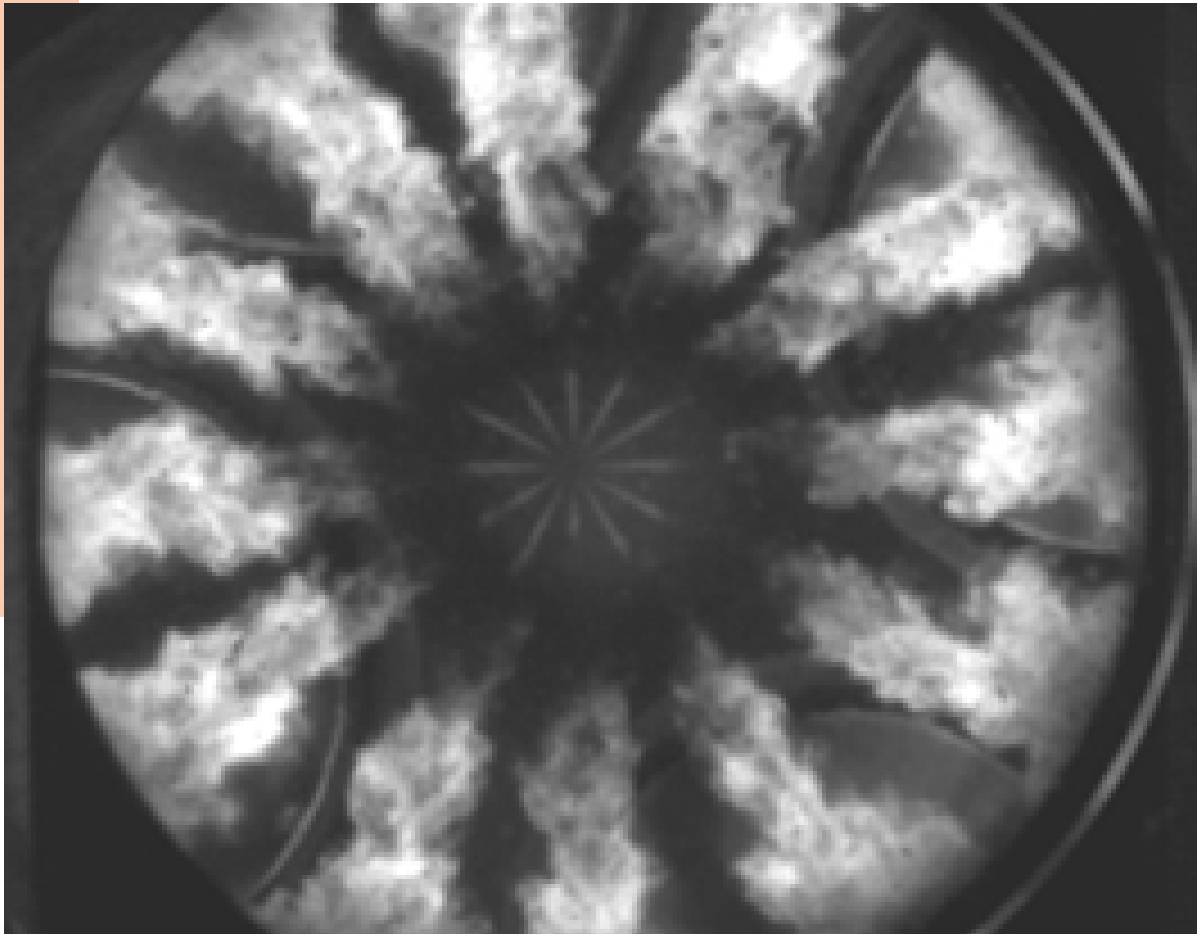


DNRF Chair:
Bengt Håkan Johansson

Period:
April 2025 – March 2028

Host institution:
Technical University of Denmark

The expected outcome of Bengt Håkan Johansson's DNRF Chair is the first demonstration ever of an internal combustion engine that switches combustion mode and all by itself selects which mode is best. If external conditions such as ambient pressure and temperature change, the operational range of the modes will change. The AI-controlled engine will then automatically adapt.





DNRF Chair:
Mohammad Bahram

Period:
January 2025 – December 2027

Host institution:
Aarhus University

Mohammad Bahram's research aims to decipher the dynamics of plant-soil-microbe interactions, exploring how these relationships drive ecosystem functioning and resilience. He seeks to build an understanding that supports sustainable, climate-resilient agriculture by leveraging cutting-edge molecular and modelling techniques.





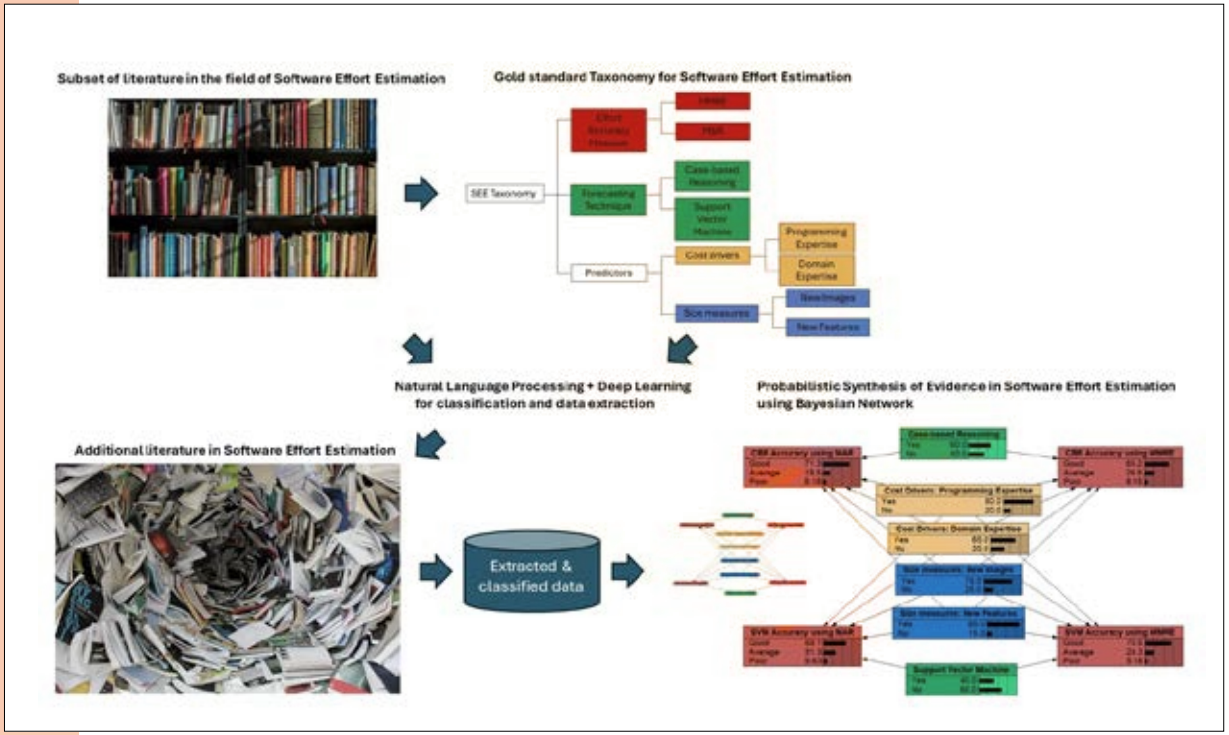
DNRF Chair:
Emilia Mendes

Period:
June 2024 - May 2027

Host institution:
Aarhus University

The purpose of this DNRF Chair project is to significantly improve our scientific understanding of Software Effort Estimation (SEE) by means of a pioneering solution that includes an effort estimation gold standard taxonomy and the meta-synthesis of the effort estimation corpus using a technique that probabilistically quantifies the relationship between variables. To describe this meta-synthesis solution, the project coined the term: probabilistic meta-synthesis of evidence.

The research involves the proposal of a gold standard taxonomy for SEE, its use with Natural Language Processing and Artificial Intelligence to classify and extract data from a large corpus of SEE studies and finally the use of such classified and extracted data, in combination with a Bayesian network, to build a probabilistic synthesis of evidence for SEE.



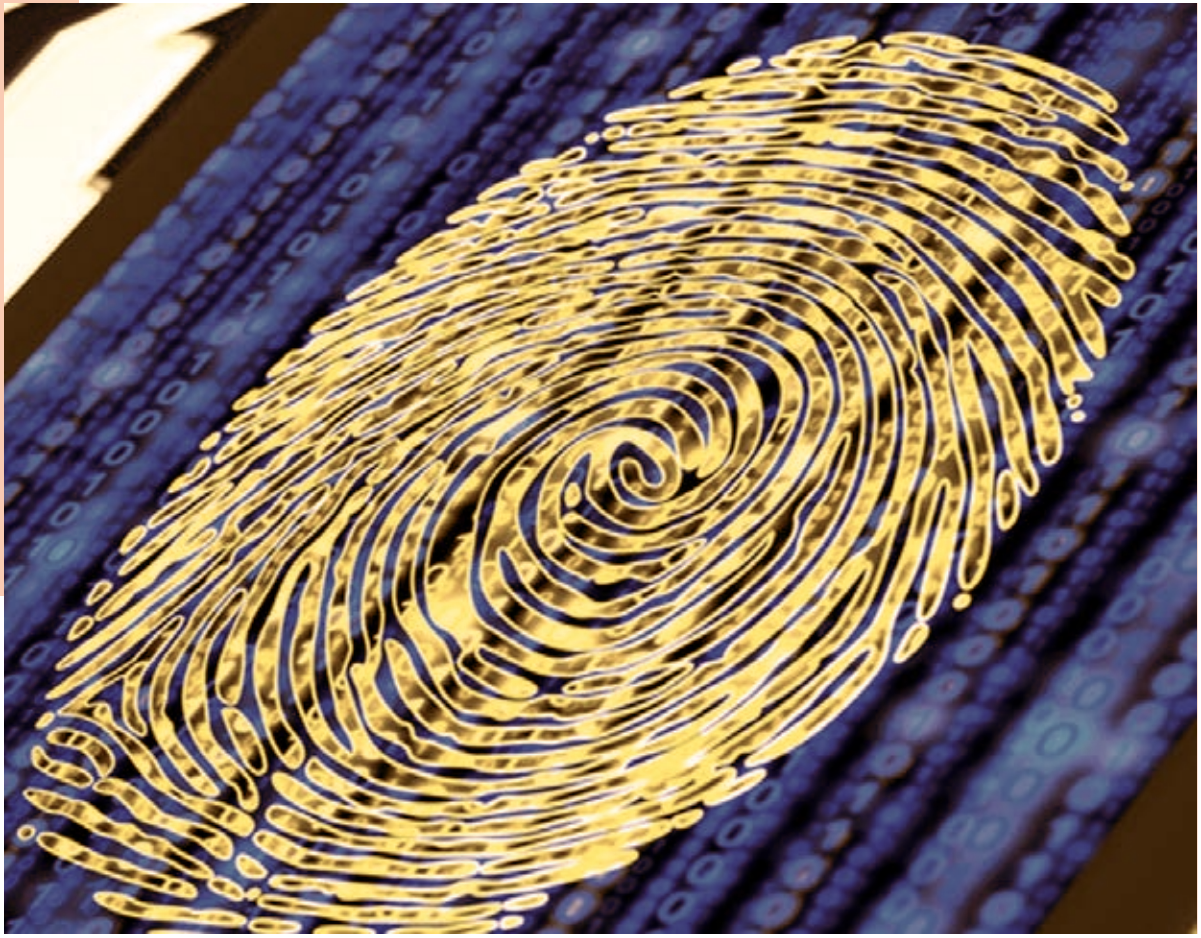


DNRF Chair:
Rasmus Kleis Nielsen

Period:
March 2025 - February 2028

Host institution:
University of Copenhagen

The aim of this project is to understand how power is exercised over platform companies such as Google, Meta, and their competitors by actors who have neither economic nor formal legislative means. The focus is on how civil society groups, interest groups, and companies from other sectors actively try to shape how platform companies operate.



Ongoing activities



Ongoing activities

CENTERS OF EXCELLENCE ESTABLISHED IN 2015 (8TH ROUND)

Center for Chromosome Stability (CCS)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Ian D. Hickson
Total grant:	DKK 110.0 million



Center for Music in the Brain (MIB)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Peter Vuust
Total grant:	DKK 98.2 million



Center for Carbon Dioxide Activation (CADIAC)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Troels Skrydstrup
Total grant:	DKK 85.0 million



Center for Urban Network Evolutions (UrbNet)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Rubina Raja
Total grant:	DKK 105.1 million



Center for Neuroplasticity and Pain (CNAP)

Location:	Aalborg University
Center leader:	Professor Thomas Graven-Nielsen
Total grant:	DKK 85.2 million



Center for Intelligent Oral Drug Delivery and Sensing using Microcontainers and Nanomechanics (IDUN)

Location:	Technical University of Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Anja Boisen
Total grant:	DKK 96.0 million



Center for Silicon Photonics for Optical Communications (SPOC)

Location:	Technical University of Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Leif Katsuo Oxenløwe
Total grant:	DKK 100.6 million



Center for Autophagy, Recycling and Disease (CARD)

Location:	The Danish Cancer Society
Center leader:	Professor Marja Jäättelä
Total grant:	DKK 95.4 million



Center for Personalized Medicine Managing Infectious Complications in Immune Deficiency (PERSIMUNE)

Location:	Rigshospitalet
Center leader:	Professor Jens Lundgren
Total grant:	DKK 100.1 million



CENTERS OF EXCELLENCE ESTABLISHED IN 2017/2018 (9TH ROUND)

Center for Proteins in Memory (PROMEMO)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Anders Nykjær
Total grant:	DKK 115.1 million



Center for Economic Behavior and Inequality (CEBI)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Claus Thustrup Kreiner
Total grant:	DKK 96.8 million



Center for Cellular Signal Patterns (CellPAT)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Jørgen Kjems
Total grant:	DKK 85.0 million



Center for Electromicrobiology (CEM)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Lars Peter Nielsen
Total grant:	DKK 100.7 million



Center for Microbial Secondary Metabolites (CeMiSt)

Location:	Technical University of Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Lone Gram
Total grant:	DKK 104.3 million



Center for Privacy Studies (PRIVACY)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Mette Birkedal Bruun
Total grant:	DKK 83.0 million



Center for Hybrid Quantum Networks (Hy-Q)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Anders S. Sørensen
Total grant:	DKK 102.0 million



The Cosmic Dawn Center (DAWN)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Sune Toft
Total grant:	DKK 117.7 million



Center for Functional Genomics and Tissue Plasticity (ATLAS)

Location:	University of Southern Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Susanne Mandrup
Total grant:	DKK 118.1 million



Center for Macroscopic Quantum States (BigQ)

Location:	Technical University of Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Ulrik Lund Andersen
Total grant:	DKK 108.9 million



CENTERS OF EXCELLENCE ESTABLISHED IN 2020/2021 (10TH ROUND)

Center for Evolutionary Hologenomics (CEH)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Marcus Thomas Pius Gilbert
Total grant:	DKK 68.1 million



Center for the Experimental-Philosophical Study of Discrimination (CEPDISC)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Kasper Lippert-Rasmussen
Total grant:	DKK 63.0 million



Danish center for Hadal research (HADAL)

Location:	University of Southern Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Ronnie Nøhr Glud
Total grant:	DKK 54.6 million



Center for Visualizing Catalytic Processes (VISION)

Location:	Technical University of Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Stig Helveg
Total grant:	DKK 85.8 million



Center for Nanophotonics (NanoPhoton)

Location:	Technical University of Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Jesper Mørk
Total grant:	DKK 62.9 million



Center for Molecular Prediction of Inflammatory Bowel Disease (PREDICT)

Location:	Aalborg University
Center leader:	Professor Tine Jess
Total grant:	DKK 68.8 million



Center for High Entropy Alloys Catalysis (CHEAC)

Location:	Technical University of Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Jan Rossmeisl
Total grant:	DKK 61.3 million



Center for Interstellar Catalysis (InterCat)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Liv Hornekær
Total grant:	DKK 67.8 million



Copenhagen Center for Geometry and Topology (GeoTop)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Nathalie Wahl
Total grant:	DKK 60.5 million



DNRF CHAIRS ESTABLISHED IN 2020-2024

Professor Morten Ørregaard Nielsen



Location:	Aarhus University
Total grant:	DKK 7.1 million

Professor Staffan Persson



Location:	University of Copenhagen
Total grant:	DKK 8.0 million

Professor Peter Jørgensen



Location:	Aarhus University
Total grant:	DKK 7.9 million

Professor Vivek Shende



Location:	University of Southern Denmark
Total grant:	DKK 8.0 million

Professor Anders Johansen



Location:	University of Copenhagen
Total grant:	DKK 8.5 million

Professor Samir Bhatt



Location:	University of Copenhagen
Total grant:	DKK 6.8 million

Professor Ruth Loos



Location:	University of Copenhagen
Total grant:	DKK 8.0 million

Professor Vitor Cardoso



Location:	University of Copenhagen
Total grant:	DKK 9.8 million

Professor Gregory Clark



Location:	University of Southern Denmark
Total grant:	DKK 10.0 million

Professor Ana Cvejic



Location:	University of Copenhagen
Total grant:	DKK 9.4 million

Professor Vijay Tiwari



Location:	University of Southern Denmark
Total grant:	DKK 9.9 million

Professor Hanna Marjaana Tuomisto



Location:	Aarhus University
Total grant:	DKK 10.0 million

Professor Amir Yehudayoff

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Total grant:	DKK 7.5 million



Professor Emilia Mendes

Location:	Aarhus University
Total grant:	DKK 5.6 million



Professor Mohammad Bahram

Location:	Aarhus University
Total grant:	DKK 10.0 million



Professor Rasmus Kleis Nielsen

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Total grant:	DKK 9.9 million



PIONEER CENTERS ESTABLISHED IN 2021-2024

Pioneer Center for Artificial Intelligence

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Serge Belongie
Total grant:	DKK 144.0 million



Pioneer Center for Landscape Research in Sustainable Agricultural Futures

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Klaus Butterbach-Bahl
Total grant:	DKK 70.0 million



Pioneer Center for Accelerating P2X Materials Discovery

Location:	Technical University of Denmark
Center leader:	Professor Tejs Vegge
Total grant:	DKK 116.0 million



Pioneer Center for Statistical and computational Methods for Advanced Research to Transform Biomedicine

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Naomi Wray
Total grant:	DKK 80.0 million



CENTERS OF EXCELLENCE ESTABLISHED IN 2022/2023 (11TH ROUND)

Center for Immunology in Viral Infections (CiViA)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Søren Riis Paludan
Total grant:	DKK 60.0 million



Center for Polariton-driven light-matter (POLIMA)

Location:	University of Southern Denmark
Center leader:	Professor N. Asger Mortensen
Total grant:	DKK 60.4 million



Center for Gene Expression (CGEN)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Jesper Svejstrup
Total grant:	DKK 69.0 million



Center for Big Data in Finance (BIGFI)

Location:	Copenhagen Business School
Center leader:	Professor Lasse Heje Pedersen
Total grant:	DKK 59.8 million



Center for Volatile Interactions (VOLT)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Riikka Rinnan
Total grant:	DKK 60.0 million



Center for Global Mobility Law (MOBILE)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Thomas Gammeltoft-Hansen
Total grant:	DKK 36.4 million



Center for Interdisciplinary Study of Pandemic Signatures (Pandemix)

Location:	Roskilde University
Center leader:	Professor Lone Simonsen
Total grant:	DKK 47.4 million



Centre for Culture and the Mind (CULTMIND)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor with special responsibilities Ana Antic
Total grant:	DKK 39.4 million



Center for Chemistry of Clouds (C3)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Merete Bilde
Total grant:	DKK 60.4 million



Center for Ecological Dynamics in a Novel Biosphere (ECONOVO)

Location:	Aarhus University
Center leader:	Professor Jens-Christian Svenning
Total grant:	DKK 60.4 million



Centre for Ancient Environmental Genomics (CAEG)

Location:	University of Copenhagen
Center leader:	Professor Eske Willerslev
Total grant:	DKK 75.0 million



COURSE ACTIVITIES FOR CENTER LEADERS/ OUTREACH PROGRAM FOR CENTERS

Total grant:	DKK 15.2 million

Financial reports

- **Statement by management on the annual report**
- **Total assets and return on investment**
- **Independent auditor's report**
- **Accounting policies**
- **Income statement**
  January 1 – December 31
- **Balance sheet December 31**
- **Statement of changes in net capital**
  for 2024
- **Notes**



Statement by management on the annual report

The board and the CEO have today considered and approved the annual report of the Danish National Research Foundation for the financial year 2024.

The annual report is presented in accordance with the Consolidated Act on the Danish National Research Foundation, the Danish Executive Order on the Administration of the Funds of the Danish National Research Foundation, the Royal Decree on the Charter of the Danish National Research Foundation and the provisions of the Danish Financial Statements Act with the adjustments resulting from the special nature of the Danish National Research Foundation.

In our opinion, the annual accounts give a true and fair view of the foundation's financial position as of December 31, 2024, and of the results of its operations during the financial year from January 1 to December 31, 2024. In addition, we believe that the management commentary contains a fair review of the affairs and represents referred to therein.

Finally, it is our opinion that the established administrative procedures and internal controls covered by the financial statements comply with the appropriations granted, statutes, other regulations, agreements and usual practice, and that sound financial management is exercised in the administration of the funds and activities covered by the financial statements.

Copenhagen, April 8, 2025.

Niels Mejlgaard (CEO)

Board members:

Dorthe Dahl-Jensen (Chair)

Christian S. Jensen (Vice Chair)

Anna Dreber Almenberg

Stefan Hecht

Tine Brink Henriksen

Sirpa Jalkanen

Dorte Juul Jensen

Tore Rem

Janet M. Thornton

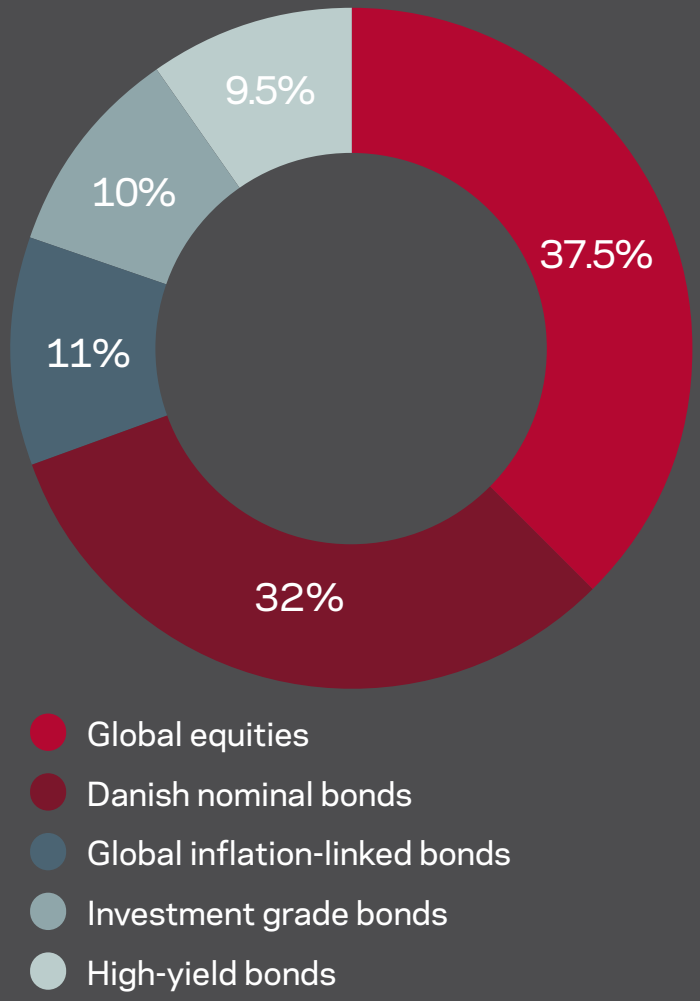
Total assets and return on investment 2024

Overall, global equity markets in 2024 experienced strong performance, mainly fueled by stable economic growth particularly in the USA. Lower inflation resulted in central banks lowering policy rates, however the development in the bond yields were more diverse where the US treasury yields went up while the Danish treasure yield went down in 2024. The bond markets generally benefited from the higher interest rates. The higher yield level (compared to the low-yield-era) contributed to positive returns from the bond portfolios. Corporate bonds benefited from lower credit spreads during 2024.

In 2024, the foundation realized a return on investment of 10.6%; total return on investment was DKK 505 million. Broken down into asset classes, return on equities amounted to DKK 377 million, while the return on the fixed income portfolio amounted to DKK 128 million.

Net capital at the end of 2024 was DKK 4,790 million, compared to net capital of DKK 4,761 million at the end of 2023. The foundation distributed DKK 458 million to its grant holders in 2024. Administrative expenses, including depreciation, were DKK 13.3 million in 2024.

The strategic asset allocation remained unchanged during 2024 and is shown in the figure below.



Total return

Calculated as a time-weighted return, the total return on investment in 2024 was 10.6%, which was in line with the benchmark return of 10.5%. The primary reason for the excess performance was due to strong excess performance from equities, Danish nominal bonds, and European corporate bonds.

From a five-year perspective, covering the period 2020 to 2024, the foundation's annual return of 4.0% was higher than the annual benchmark's return of 3.8 %. The return in 2024 on the different asset types is presented in the table.

Comments on the 2024 return for the different asset types are below.

Return on investment	**2024**	**2023**	**2022**	**2021**	**2020**
Bonds and cash, million DKK	127.8	211.5	-484.0	-8.7	104.1
Equities, million DKK	377.2	338.6	-372.0	441.4	251.5
Total return, million DKK	**505.0**	**550.1**	**-856.0**	**432.7**	**355.6**
Foundation return, %[1]	10.6	12.1	-14.2	7.5	6.4
Benchmark return, %	10.5	11.7	-14.1	7.7	5.7
Foundation 5 years p.a. return, %[2]	4.0	4.1	1.1	5.7	5.6
Benchmark 5 years p.a. return, %[2]	3.8	3.9	0.9	5.4	5.3

1 *The annual return on the total investment is a weighted average of each portfolio's return.*
2 *The geometric mean.*

Return in percent (%)				
Asset type	**Weight**	**DNRF**	**Benchmark**	**Benchmark name**
Global equities	37.5	27.6	27.5	MSCI World (until end June) MSCI World Climate Paris Aligned Index TR Net (from July)
Currency hedge (equities)		-3.9	-3.9	-
Emerging Markets equities		13.4	12.8	MSCI EM Climate Change Index TR Net
Danish nominal bonds	32	4.9	4.5	25% Nordea GCM DK Gov. Bonds CM 5 75% Nordea Mortgage bonds
Global inflation-linked bonds	11	0.8	1.1	Barclays Global Inflation-linked Bond index 1-10 Y (95% Hedged)
European investment grade bonds	10	5.3	4.9	Barclays Capital Euro Major Corporate (ex. tobacco & weapon)
US high-yield bonds	9.5	4.7	5.8	ML US Cash Pay HY Constrained TR H (Hedged to DKK)
Total	100.0	10.6	10.5	

Return on equities

The foundation's equity portfolio consists of a combination of equities in developed countries and emerging markets countries. The emerging markets include China, South Korea, Brazil, Mexico, Taiwan, India, and others. The split between developed and emerging countries in the portfolio follows the breakdown in MSCI's benchmark for global equities (MSCI ACWI).

The developed market equities portfolio is managed by Nykredit Asset Management and is an indexed mandate, meaning the composition of the portfolio is almost aligned with the benchmark composition. The return from the portfolio was 27.6%, matching nearly the benchmark return of 27.5%. 80% of the exposure to USD and JPY in the equity portfolio is hedged to EUR. The increase in the USD/DKK resulted in a loss on the currency hedge while the JPY appreciated by 5% compared to DKK adding positively to the currency hedge. The total loss from the currency hedge was 3.9% in 2024.

Overall, 2024 was a good year for equities with the US stock market showing good performance. In the USA the largest contributors to the return in 2024 (like in 2023) were the very large companies within technology. An important theme among the investors was the high expectations linked to artificial intelligence. The giant chip producer, Nvidia Corp., benefited from this with the stock rising over 170 % in 2024 alone. The stock prices of other large US technology companies also performed very well in 2024.

The benchmark for the developed markets equity portfolio was changed from the market weighted benchmark (MSCI World index) to MSCI World Climate Paris Aligned index on July 1, 2024. The main reason that the market weighted benchmark no longer reflected the equity portfolio – as many companies were excluded from the investment universe due to the foundation's responsible investment policy.

The emerging markets equity portfolio is passively managed (indexed) by Danske Bank Asset Management and represents an average of 3.7% of the total assets during 2024. The return from the emerging markets equity portfolio was 13.4%, higher than the benchmark return (MSCI EM Climate Change Index) of 12.8%. The portfolio's return was higher than the benchmark's return, due to the exclusion of certain companies that did not meet the mutual fund's responsible investment policy.

The emerging markets equity portfolio return was primarily driven by China and Taiwan, though South Korea and Brazil dragged the performance down. From a sector perspective, Financials and IT contributed positively to the return, whereas Materials and Consumer Staples had a negative impact.

Return on bonds
In 2024, the global bond market saw a modest recovery as central banks began lowering interest rates to support economic growth. While inflation concerns persisted, higher bond yields made fixed-income investments more attractive than previously. This is reflected in the positive returns on all the fixed income mandates.

The Danish nominal bond portfolio represents 32% of the portfolio and is managed by Nykredit Asset Management. The portfolio yielded a return of 4.9%, above the benchmark's return of 4.5%. The excess return stems from a general overweight in callable bonds and an overweight in high-coupon callable bonds (primarily bond with a coupon of 5%). Additionally, an overweight (compared to the benchmark weight) in adjustable-rate mortgages (flex-bonds) and floaters against government bonds added to the excess return due to the tightening of the interest rate spread between Danish government and mortgage bonds.

The global inflation-linked bond portfolio is managed by Danske Bank Asset Management. The portfolio gave a return of 0.8%, below the benchmark's return of 1.1%. The portfolio's underperformance compared to the benchmark is caused by a missing exposure to Spain due to portfolio restrictions. To compensate for the missing exposure to Spain, French bonds were purchased, and these experienced a higher loss compared to the other countries in Europe because of the political unrest in France.

The total return of European corporate bonds in 2024 was 5.3% while the benchmark's return was 4.9%. Danske Bank Asset Management managed the European corporate bonds from the start of the year to mid-December, when Nordea Asset Management took over after an EU-tender had been conducted. The return from the portfolio was higher than the benchmark's return due to security selection with an overweight of real estate and banks in the portfolio.

DONATION OF 500,000 DKK FROM THE J.H. SCHULTZ FOUNDATION

J.H. Schultz Foundation has been a stable supporter of basic science in Denmark by giving donations to the DNRF. The board of the J.H. Schultz Foundation in 2024 decided again to donate 500,000 DKK to the DNRF. This is greatly appreciated by the foundation as the donation endorses the foundation's mission and the research work done by the grant holders. J.H. Schultz Foundation is the main shareholder in the Schultz Group.

The US corporate bond (high-yield) portfolio is managed by Columbia Threadneedle. During 2024, the high-yield bond portfolio had a return of 4.7%, which is below the benchmark return of 5.4%. The relative performance was below the benchmark primarily due to management fees. High-yield total returns were resilient following double digit returns in 2023. Credit spreads tightened 0.49 percentage points as macroeconomic data came in better than expected and corporate earnings generally met expectations, resulting in positive returns for the asset class.

Independent auditor's report

Opinion
We have audited the financial statements of The Danish National Research Foundation for the financial year 01.01.2024 - 31.12.2024, which comprise the income statement, balance sheet, statement of changes in equity, and notes, including a summary of significant accounting policies. The financial statements are prepared in accordance with the Danish Financial Statements Act subject to the adjustments caused by the special nature of the Foundation.

In our opinion, the financial statements give a true and fair view of the Foundation's financial position on 31.12.2024 and of the results of its operations for the financial year 01.01.2024 - 31.12.2024 in accordance with the Danish Financial Statements Act subject to the adjustments caused by the special nature of the Foundation.

Basis for opinion
We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (ISAs) and additional requirements applicable in Denmark, and the Danish Standards on Public-Sector Auditing (SOR), as the audit is performed based on the provisions of the Act on the Danish National Research Foundation, see Consolidated Act No. 200 of 26 February 2019. Our requirement under those standards and responsibilities are further described in the *"Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements"* section of this auditor's report.

The auditor general is independent of the Foundation in accordance with section 1(6) of the Danish Auditor General Act, and the approved auditor is independent of the Foundation in accordance with the International Ethics Standards Board for Accountants' International Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (IESBA Code) and the additional ethical requirements applicable in Denmark, and we have both fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these rules and requirements.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Management's responsibilities for the financial statements
Management is responsible for the preparation of financial statements that give a true and fair view in accordance with the Danish Financial Statements Act subject to the adjustments caused by the special nature of the Foundation, and for such internal control as Management determines is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, Management is responsible for assessing the Foundation's ability to continue as a going concern, for disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern, and for using the going concern basis of accounting in preparing the financial statements unless Management either intends to liquidate the Foundation or to cease operations or has no realistic alternative but to do so.

Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements
Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs and the additional requirements applicable in Denmark, and the Danish Standards on Public-Sector Auditing (SOR), as the audit is performed based on the provisions of the Act on the Danish National Research Foundation,

see Consolidated Act No. 200 of 26 February 2019, will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

As part of an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs and the additional requirements applicable in Denmark, and the Danish Standards on Public-Sector Auditing (SOR), as the audit is performed based on the provisions of the Act on the Danish National Research Foundation, see Consolidated Act No. 200 of 26 February 2019, we exercise professional judgement and maintain professional skepticism throughout the audit. We also:

- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the financial statements, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than for one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control.
- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the Foundation's internal control.
- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates and related disclosures made by Management.
- Conclude on the appropriateness of Management's use of the going concern basis of accounting in preparing the financial statements, and, based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the Foundation's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in our auditor's report to the related disclosures in the financial statements or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify our opinion. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our auditor's report. However, future events or conditions may cause the Foundation to cease to continue as a going concern.
- Evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the financial statements, including the disclosures in the notes, and whether the financial statements represent the underlying transactions and events in a manner that gives a true and fair view.

We communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that we identify during our audit.

Statement on the management commentary

Management is responsible for the management commentary.

Our opinion on the financial statements does not cover the management commentary, and we do not express any form of assurance conclusion thereon.

In connection with our audit of the financial statements, our responsibility is to read the management commentary and, in doing so, consider whether the management commentary is materially inconsistent with the financial statements, or our knowledge obtained in the audit or otherwise appears to be materially misstated.

Moreover, it is our responsibility to consider whether the management commentary provides the information required under the Danish Financial Statements Act subject to the adjustments caused by the special nature of the Foundation.

Based on the work we have performed, we conclude that the management commentary is in accordance with the financial statements and has been prepared in accordance with

the requirements of the Danish Financial Statements Act subject to the adjustments caused by the special nature of the Foundation. We did not identify any material misstatement of the management commentary.

Statement on compliance audit and performance audit

The management of the Foundation is responsible for the transactions comprised by the financial statements and for ensuring the compliance of the transactions with the applicable appropriations, legislation and other regulations as well as with any contractual obligations and generally accepted practice. The management is also responsible for the administration of the funds and the operation of the activities comprised by the financial statements and for establishing the systems and processes relevant for ensuring economy, efficiency and effectiveness in the activities of the Foundation.

As part of our engagement to audit the financial statements, it is our responsibility to conduct compliance and performance audits of selected subject matters in accordance with the Danish Standards on Public-Sector Auditing (SOR). This implies that we assess whether there is a risk of material violations of regulations in the transactions covered by the financial statements, or a risk of material performance deficiencies in the systems and processes established by the management. On the basis of our risk assessment, we determine the subject matters of which we will conduct our compliance audit or performance audit.

In a compliance audit, we verify with reasonable assurance whether the specific transactions that we have selected as the subject matter of our audit comply with the relevant criteria established by applicable appropriations, legislation, other regulations, agreements or generally accepted practice. In a performance audit, we assess with reasonable assurance whether the specific systems, processes or activities that we have selected as the subject matter of our audit exhibit due considerations to economy, efficiency and effectiveness in the operation of the Foundation and the administration of the funds covered by the financial statements.

Our audit of any given subject matter aims to obtain sufficient and appropriate audit evidence in order to conclude with reasonable assurance on the subject matter. It is not a guarantee that an audit conducted with reasonable assurance will detect any material violation in the transactions covered by the financial statements, or any material performance deficiency in the systems and processes established by the management. Since we have only conducted compliance and performance audits of selected subject matters, we cannot provide assurance that there may be no material violations of regulations or material performance deficiencies in other subject matters.

If, based on the work performed, we conclude that our audit gives rise to material critical comments, we are required to report these in this statement.

We do not have any material critical comments to report in this respect.

Copenhagen, April 8, 2025.

The auditor general (Rigsrevisionen)
CVR-nr.76806113

Henrik Lange, Head of division
Sultan Kayiran, Special consultant

Deloitte
Statsautoriseret Revisionspartnerselskab
CVR-nr. 33963556

Jens Sejer Pedersen
State Authorized Public Accountant
MNE-nr. mne14986

Kristoffer Sune Hemmingsen
State Authorized Public Accountant
MNE-nr. mne33384

Accounting policies

The annual report is presented in accordance with the Consolidated Act on the Danish National Research Foundation, the Danish Executive Order on the Administration of the Funds of the Danish National Research Foundation, the Royal Decree on the Charter of the Danish National Research Foundation and the provisions of the Danish Financial Statements Act governing reporting class C enterprises (large) with the adjustments resulting from the special nature of the foundation.

The provisions of the Danish Financial Statements Act governing reporting class C enterprises (large) prescribe preparation of a cash flow statement. Due to the nature of the foundation's activities, the cash flows cannot reasonably be broken down by cash flows from operating, investing and financing activities, for which reason the cash flow statement has been omitted, referring to Section 11(3) of the Danish Financial Statements Act. In addition, the foundation has decided to derogate from the format requirements laid down by the Danish Financial Statements Act for the income statement in order to illustrate the special nature of the foundation.

The accounting policies applied are consistent with those applied last year.

INCOME STATEMENT

Interest income
Interest income from bonds and bank deposits are accrued so it relates to the financial year under audit.

Dividend
Dividend received on shares is included in the income statement at the time of distribution.

Realized capital gains and losses on and market value adjustments of securities
Realized capital gains and losses on and market value adjustments of securities (bonds and equities) are included in the income statement.

Other income
Other income comprises general donations from private donors. The funds are recognized when transferred to the foundation.

External expenses for the scientific activities of the foundation
Such expenses comprise expenses for the foundation's scientific activities, including expenses for the consideration of applications and evaluation of grants.

Income tax
The foundation is not liable to tax.

BALANCE SHEET

Fixed assets
Leasehold improvements are recognized in the balance sheet at cost less accumulated depreciation. Fixed assets are depreciated straight-line over their estimated useful lives of five years.

Office equipment and furniture is recognized at cost less accumulated depreciation. Office equipment and furniture is depreciated

straight-line over their estimated useful lives, meaning three years for IT hardware and software and five years for other office equipment.

Assets costing less than DKK 25,000 per unit are expensed in the year of acquisition.

Securities
Listed securities (bonds and equities) are measured at fair value (quoted price) at the balance sheet date. Bonds redeemed at the time of presentation of the annual accounts are recognized at par value. Other investments are measured at the lower of the value at the date of acquisition and fair value.

Net capital
Distributions by the foundation mainly take the form of multiannual total grants awarded over a number of years concurrently with, and conditional on, the actual completion of the research projects. An amount corresponding to the unpaid share of such total grants is recognized as predisposed capital under the net capital. Other net capital is classified as non-predisposed capital. An amount corresponding to the total grants provided during the year is transferred from the non-predisposed capital to the predisposed capital. The grants paid during the year are deducted from the predisposed capital.

Foreign currency translation
Foreign currency transactions are translated into DKK applying the exchange rate at the transaction date. Realized and unrealized gains and losses are recognized in capital income in the income statement.

Bank deposits and securities denominated in foreign currencies are translated into DKK applying the balance sheet date exchange rate. Realized and unrealized foreign exchange gains and losses are recognized in capital income in the income statement.

Derivative financial instruments
The Danish National Research Foundation only applies derivative financial instruments to hedge the currency and interest rate risks involved in the portfolio of securities.

Changes in the fair value of derivative financial instruments classified as and complying with the requirement for hedging the fair value of a recognized asset or a recognized liability are recorded in the income statement together with changes in the value of the hedged asset or the hedged liability. In doing so, symmetrical recognition of gains and losses on the item hedged and the hedging instrument, respectively, is ensured.

Premiums received or paid as well as forward premiums and discounts are recognized in the income statement over the terms of the instruments. The fair value of derivative financial statements classified as and qualifying for hedging of an instrument to hedge a recognized asset or liability is recognized in the balance sheet along with the asset or liability to which hedging relates.

INCOME STATEMENT JANUARY 1 – DECEMBER 31

	Note	2024	2023
Return on investment			
Realized gains and losses, bonds		52,893,876	56,371,576
Unrealized gains and losses, bonds		74,133,482	154,291,725
Realized gains and losses, equities		122,161,044	73,748,580
Unrealized gains and losses, equities		255,012,294	264,837,576
Interest, bank deposits		771,135	865,111
Return on investment, total		**504,971,831**	**550,114,568**
Other receipts, net	1	**500,000**	**500,000**
Costs			
Custody and bank fees etc.	2	-4,853,420	-4,542,256
Salaries etc.	3	-9,273,039	-9,655,535
Office expenses	4	-678,246	-666,218
Premises	5	-1,203,089	-1,105,109
Accountant/attorney remuneration etc.	6	-1,166,573	-1,403,513
External expenses, research activities	7	-561,803	-266,900
Other expenses	8	-564,986	-445,683
Depreciation	9	-43,788	-38,525
Costs, total		**-18,344,945**	**-18,123,739**
Result for the year		**487,126,887**	**532,490,829**
Predisposed capital:			
Predisposed capital, January 1		1,621,279,043	1,395,486,793
Distribution disbursed in the year		-458,153,940	-430,839,126
Distribution rebursed in the year		32,627	22,704
Grants transfered from non-predisposed capital		310,057,372	689,597,160
Grants reverted to non-predisposed capital		0	-32,988,488
Predisposed capital, December 31		**1,473,215,102**	**1,621,279,043**

BALANCE SHEET DECEMBER 31

	Note	2024	2023
ASSETS			
Fixed assets			
Tangible fixed assets	10		
Leasehold improvements		60,046	46,761
Office equipment and furniture		36,145	0
		96,191	46,761
Fixed asset investments			
Deposits		299,661	277,653
		299,661	277,653
Fixed assets, total		395,852	324,414
Current assets			
Receivables			
Accrued interest		21,455,097	18,485,218
Other receivables		627,903	645,317
Deferred charges		1,166,501	1,477,545
		23,249,501	20,608,080
Liquid assets			
Securities, bonds	11	2,988,853,262	2,912,439,791
Securities, equities	12	1,753,817,275	1,818,608,809
Bank deposits	13	28,157,920	11,776,862
		4,770,828,457	4,742,825,462
Current assets, total		4,794,077,958	4,763,433,542
ASSETS, TOTAL		**4,794,473,810**	**4,763,757,956**
EQUITY AND LIABILITIES			
Net capital		4,790,122,274	4,761,116,700
Payables			
Short-term payables			
Payables and back costs		4,351,536	2,641,256
Payables, total		**4,351,536**	**2,641,256**
EQUITY AND LIABILITIES, TOTAL		**4,794,473,810**	**4,763,757,956**
Distribution obligations	14c		
Contingent liabilities	15		

STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN NET CAPITAL FOR 2024

	Non-Predisposed capital	Predisposed capital	Total Net Capital
Net Capital at January 1, 2024	3,139,837,657	1,621,279,043	4,761,116,700
Result for the year	487,126,887	0	487,126,887
Distribution disbursed in the year	0	-458,153,940	-458,153,940
Distribution rebursed in the year	0	32,627	32,627
Grants transferred from non-predisposed capital	-310,057,372	310,057,372	0
Grants reverted to non-predisposed capital	0	0	0
Net capital at the end of the year	**3,316,907,172**	**1,473,215,102**	**4,790,122,274**

According to the Danish Executive Order no. 325 of March 29, 2016 on the financial management of the funds of the Danish National Research Foundation, the foundation's net capital consists of the capital contributed at the formation of the Danish National Research Foundation, the return on this capital and public grants less subsequent spending and losses.

The predisposed capital includes the commitments given to the grantees of the Danish National Research Foundation to carry out the operating activities, which have not yet been paid at the balance date; see the specification in note [14a].

NOTES 1-14

	2024	2023
1 OTHER RECEIPTS, NET		
Private donation	500,000	500,000
Other receipts, total	**500,000**	**500,000**
2 CUSTODY AND BANK FEES, ETC,		
Bonds	2,522,627	2,771,948
Equities	2,302,303	1,744,127
Fees, portfolio managers	**4,824,930**	**4,516,075**
Bank	15,934	13,710
Other	12,556	12,471
Custody and bank fees, total	**4,853,420**	**4,542,256**
3 SALARIES ETC,		
CEO and board members	2,933,619	2,994,205
Severance pay provision	176,955	128,034
Salaries, other employees	5,999,431	6,192,134
Temporary employee	41,279	158,827
Wage reimbursement	-59,518	0
Pension costs	514,632	500,593
Danish Labor Market Supplementary Pension Scheme (ATP)	22,501	34,080
Salaries related to grants	-322,094	-352,339
Pensions related to grants	-33,766	0
Salaries etc,, foundation staff, total	**9,273,039**	**9,655,534**
Average staff number, accounting year	10	10
4 OFFICE EXPENSES		
Office supplies	11,131	26,661
Postage and freight	673	1,852
Telephone, Internet	74,524	107,655
Minor acquisitions	99,848	38,842
Journal, books, etc,	57,110	56,288
Software subscribtions	284,896	275,195
Servicing contracts etc,	150,064	159,725
Office expenses, total	**678,246**	**666,218**

NOTES 1-14

	2024	2023
5 PREMISES		
Rent of office	898,984	832,957
Electricity, heating	94,507	90,669
Cleaning	174,455	162,013
Repairs and maintenance	35,143	19,470
Premises, total	**1,203,089**	**1,105,109**
6 ACCOUNTANT/ATTORNEY REMUNERATION ETC,		
Accountant remuneration, Deloitte	233,095	223,725
Accountancy consultation, Deloitte	-4,375	20,000
Attorney's remuneration	419,063	207,313
Other consultancy services	518,790	952,475
Accountant/attorney remuneration etc,, total	**1,166,573**	**1,403,513**
7 EXTERNAL EXPENSES, RESEARCH ACTIVITIES		
Peer review expenses	296,354	26,520
Preparation of publications	50,021	91,305
Research presentations, meetings etc,	178,707	122,015
European Science Foundation membership fee	36,721	27,060
External expenses, research activities, total	**561,803**	**266,900**
8 OTHER EXPENSES		
Travelling and accomodation	209,414	168,281
Advertising	28,719	0
Entertainment expenses, gifts	800	862
Courses	41,153	40,999
Insurance	136,950	127,740
Cost of staff and board	147,950	107,801
Other expenses, total	**564,986**	**445,683**
9 DEPRECIATION		
Leasehold improvements, see note 10	25,715	38,525
Office furniture and equipment, see note 10	18,073	0
Depreciation, total	**43,788**	**38,525**

			2024
	Leasehold improvements	Office equipment and furniture	Total
10 TANGIBLE FIXED ASSETS			
Acquisition cost, January 1, 2024	2,327,819	664,462	2,992,281
Additions	39,000	54,217	93,217
Disposals	0	-18,613	-18,613
Acquisition cost, December 31, 2024	**2,366,819**	**700,066**	**3,066,885**
Depreciation, accumulated, January 1, 2024	-2,281,057	-664,462	-2,945,519
Depreciation for the year	-25,715	-18,073	-43,788
Reversed depreciation, disposals for the year	0	18,613	18,613
Depreciation, accumulated, December 31, 2024	**-2,306,772**	**-663,922**	**-2,970,694**
Book value at year-end	**60,047**	**36,144**	**96,191**

	2024	2023
11 SECURITIES, BONDS		
Asset classes		
Danish bonds	1,516,935,687	1,489,300,839
European corporate bonds	478,052,693	461,861,567
Global inflation-linked bonds	522,141,369	521,769,247
US High yield bonds *	471,723,513	439,508,138
Bonds, total	**2,988,853,262**	**2,912,439,791**

** Option adjusted duration, December 31, 2024: 3.1 (December 31, 2023: 3.1).*

Danish bonds **Distribution by type of security:**		
Mortgage bonds	1,516,445,482	1,488,786,052
Government bonds	0	0
Other bonds	490,205	514,787
	1,516,935,687	**1,489,300,839**

Option adjusted duration, December 31, 2024: 4.7 (December 31, 2023: 5.0).

NOTES 1-14

	2024	2023
European corporate bonds		
Distribution by rating category and forward currency contract:		
AAA	11,760,096	0
AA	6,883,959	2,295,954
A	125,871,274	89,776,480
BBB	319,339,199	369,789,133
BB	5,784,438	0
Not rated	8,270,312	0
Cash	143,416	0
	478,052,694	**461,861,567**
Rating category according to Standard & Poor's Long-Term Credit Rating, Option adjusted duration, December 31, 2024: 4.6 (December 31, 2023: 4.4).		
Global inflation-linked bonds		
Distribution by country and forward currency contract:		
Canada	4,587,952	4,653,563
Germany	23,964,165	18,530,852
France	91,722,062	69,226,882
Great Britain	61,945,589	55,342,708
USA	333,950,652	358,770,122
New Zeeland	1,787,213	1,846,518
Sweden	3,244,228	3,328,586
Australia	6,674,765	6,841,944
Forward currency contracts	-5,735,257	3,228,072
	522,141,369	**521,769,247**
Adjusted duration, December 31, 2024: 2.6 (December 31, 2023: 2.4).		
12 SECURITIES, EQUITIES		
Nykredit Bank A/S	1,588,829,249	1,617,835,777
Withholding tax reclaims Nykredit Bank A/S	1,675,752	1,208,354
Withholding tax reclaims NT	637,082	746,319
Danske Invest Index Global Emerging Markets, Acc., DKK	186,453,165	177,861,523
Forward currency contracts and swaps	-23,777,973	20,956,836
Equities, total	**1,753,817,275**	**1,818,608,809**
13 LIQUID ASSETS		
Cash	675	5,253
Current bank accounts	24,255,707	671,091
Portfolio accounts	3,901,538	11,100,518
Liquid assets, total	**28,157,920**	**11,776,862**

NOTE 14A

14A DISTRIBUTION OBLIGATIONS

2024 distributions and total grants, DKK thousand

Grant no.		Grant 1st period	Grant 2nd period	Changes in 2024	Grants total	Disbursed 2024	Residual disbursement expected
Closed grants		4,338,355	2,897,575	0	7,235,930	0	0
Course activities for center leaders/outreach program							
88.	Management course/communication	3,550	7,600	4,000	15,150	630	4,303
Centers established in 2015							
115.	Center for Chromosome Stability	65,000	45,000		110,000	11,497	5,460
117.	Center for Music in the Brain	52,207	45,946		98,153	12,905	7,871
118.	Center for Carbon Dioxide Activation	60,000	25,000		85,000	5,809	1,418
119.	Center for Urban Network Evolutions	65,000	40,000	86	105,086	9,114	7,031
121.	Center for Neuroplasticity and Pain	60,242	25,000		85,242	5,902	3,648
122.	Center for Intelligent Oral Drug Delivery and Sensing using Microcontainers and Nanomechanics	56,000	40,000		96,000	10,185	7,948
123.	Center for Silicon Photonics for Optical Communications	59,000	41,594		100,594	11,896	5,099
125.	Center for Autophagy, Recycling and Disease	50,000	45,372		95,372	8,695	3,593
126.	Center for Personalized Medicine Managing Infectious Complications in Immune Deficiency	60,000	40,055		100,055	9,784	602
Centers established in 2017 and 2018							
133.	Center for Proteins in Memory	62,000	53,100		115,100	14,785	36,989
134.	Center for Economic Behavior and Inequality	57,000	39,800		96,800	10,890	32,537
135.	Center for Cellular Signal Patterns	61,000	24,000	-32	84,968	5,088	18,880
136.	Center for Electromicrobiology	56,000	44,700		100,700	12,731	30,625
137.	Center for Microbial Secondary Metabolites	58,000	46,300		104,300	11,673	38,370
138.	Center for Privacy Studies	50,000	33,000		83,000	9,354	22,802
139.	Center for Hybrid Quantum Networks	62,000		40,000	102,000	6,897	34,938
140.	The Cosmic Dawn Center	66,173		51,510	117,683	12,300	43,286
141.	Center for Functional Genomics and Tissue Plasticity	65,000		53,100	118,100	9,314	43,786
142.	Center for Macroscopic Quantum States	63,000		45,900	108,900	10,007	40,370

NOTE 14A

14A DISTRIBUTION OBLIGATIONS

2024 distributions and total grants, DKK thousand

Grant no.		Grant 1st period	Grant 2nd period	Changes in 2024	Grants total	Disbursed 2024	Residual disbursement expected
Centers established in 2020 and 2021							
143.	Center for Evolutionary Hologenomics	68,014			68,014	9,825	7,631
144.	Center for the Experimental-Philosophical Study of Discrimination	62,986			62,986	15,073	17,703
145.	Danish center for Hadal Research	54,612			54,612	9,538	18,162
146.	Center for Visualizing Catalytic Processes	85,826			85,826	11,350	32,781
147.	Center for Nanophotonics	62,856			62,856	11,826	17,779
148.	Center for Molecular Prediction of Inflammatory Bowel Disease	68,830			68,830	13,758	27,113
149.	Center for High Entropy Alloys Catalysis	61,306			61,306	11,603	21,487
150.	Center for Interstellar Catalysis	67,742			67,742	12,793	15,741
151.	Copenhagen Center for Geometry and Topology	60,529			60,529	11,806	20,338
152.	Center for Complex Quantum Systems	35,136			35,136	4,421	1,572
DNRF Chair established in 2020 to 2024							
153.	Jesper Svejstrup, University of Copenhagen	15,000		-2	14,998	0	-2
154.	Morten Ørregaard Nielsen, Aarhus University	7,114			7,114	1,898	811
155.	Steffan Persson, University of Copenhagen	8,000			8,000	2,507	0
156.	Peter Jørgensen, Aarhus University	7,928			7,928	2,229	0
157.	Vivek Shende, University of Southern Denmark	8,000			8,000	1,678	0
159.	Anders Johansen, University of Copenhagen	8,500			8,500	3,476	410
160.	Samir Bhatt, University of Copenhagen	6,820			6,820	2,369	2,020
161.	Ruth Loos, University of Copenhagen	8,000			8,000	3,985	2,098
162.	Vitor Cardoso, University of Copenhagen	9,772			9,772	3,613	2,043
163.	Gregory Clark, University of Southern Denmark	10,000			10,000	2,921	5,772
176.	Ana Cvejic, University of Copenhagen	9,352			9,352	1,816	7,168
177.	Vijay Tiwari, University of Southern Denmark	9,920			9,920	1,628	8,292
179.	Hanna Marjaana Tuomisto, Aarhus University	9,987			9,987	2,097	7,672
180.	Amir Yehudayoff, University of Copenhagen			7,487	7,487	630	6,857
181.	Emilia Mendes, Aarhus University			5,562	5,562	0	5,562
183.	Mohammad Bahram, Aarhus University			10,000	10,000	0	10,000
197.	Rasmus Kleis Nielsen, University of Copenhagen			9,927	9,927	0	9,927

14A DISTRIBUTION OBLIGATIONS

2024 distributions and total grants, DKK thousand

Grant no.		Grant 1st period	Grant 2nd period	Changes in 2024	Grants total	Disbursed 2024	Residual disbursement expected
Pioneer Centers established in 2021 to 2024							
158.	Pioneer Center for Artificial Intelligence	144,000			144,000	14,940	110,115
175.	Pioneer Center for Landscape Research in Sustainable Agricultural Futures	70,000			70,000	6,541	58,021
178.	Pioneer center for Accelerating P2X Materials Discovery	116,000			116,000	7,103	107,525
182.	Pioneer center for Statistical and computational Methods for Advanced Research to Transform Biomedicine			80,000	80,000	192	79,808
Centers established in 2022 and 2023							
164.	Center for Immunology in Viral Infections	60,000			60,000	11,334	46,232
165.	Center for Polariton-driven light-matter	59,960		360	60,320	10,027	43,904
166.	Center for Gene Expression	68,999			68,999	14,361	42,033
167.	Center for Big Data in Finance	59,399		360	59,759	7,666	45,543
168.	Center for Volatile Interactions	60,000			60,000	10,609	44,210
169.	Center for Global Mobility Law	36,000		360	36,360	5,230	27,168
170.	Center for Interdisciplinary Study of Pandemic Signatures	47,000		360	47,360	5,553	39,027
171.	Centre for Culture and the Mind	38,982		360	39,342	4,617	32,542
172.	Center for Chemistry of Clouds	59,998		359	60,357	5,892	51,371
173.	Center for Ecological Dynamics in a Novel Biosphere	59,998		360	60,358	9,274	49,133
174.	Centre for Ancient Environmental Genomics	75,000			75,000	12,486	58,090
Grant and distribution, total		**7,171,093**	**3,494,043**	**310,057**	**10,975,193**	**458,121**	**1,473,215**

The number of grants listed in the key figures includes the grants for which the foundation has disbursed in 2024

NOTE 14B

14B ANNUAL DISBURSEMENTS, DKK THOUSAND:

Year	Disbursed	Expected disbursements to activities listed above	Total
1993	19,133		
1994	141,708		
1995	154,509		
1996	176,194		
1997	200,876		
1998	247,751		
1999	243,346		
2000	224,484		
2001	228,789		
2002	256,877		
2003	239,915		
2004	173,489		
2005	195,185		
2006	195,225		
2007	242,803		
2008	321,277		
2009	274,998		
2010	387,270		
2011	358,754		
2012	390,990		
2013	423,039		
2014	435,944		
2015	424,512		
2016	381,286		
2017	384,769		
2018	409,292		
2019	414,417		
2020	335,205		
2021	359,967		
2022	371,037		
2023	430,816		
2024	458,121		
2025		503,630	
2026		394,145	
2027		262,113	
2028		135,237	
2029		46,010	
2030		35,259	
2031		29,779	
2032		24,056	
2033		21,692	
2034		16,128	
2035		3,527	
2036		1,639	
	9,501,978	**1,473,215**	**10,975,193**

The disbursements specified above are distributed according to the expected year of disbursement.

Disbursements are made on the basis of the grant holders' revised budgets, In consequence, the final presentation of accounts to the foundation may result in adjustments of the disbursements for the following years.

NOTES 14C-15

14C EXPECTED DISTRIBUTIONS 2025 - 2029

In addition to the distribution obligations listed in notes 14a and 14b, new grants are expected to be established as a result of application rounds for Centers of Excellence. Total (including given and planned) distributions are expected to be as follows:

Year	Million DKK
2025	605
2026	526
2027	605
2028	515
2029	471
	2,722

15 CONTINGENT LIABILITIES

The foundation has to give six months' notice to terminate the tenancy agreement. The obligation amounts to DKK 459.352.

The foundation has entered into forward and futures currency and currency swaps for the purchase and sale of the following currencies (amounts calculated in the currencies in question):

		2024
Currency	Purchase	Sale
USD	8,608,000	190,949,400
JPY	48,000,000	1,196,020,000
CAD	0	913,000
EUR	198,680,547	9,441,537
GBP	282,000	7,089,000
NZD	0	441,000
AUD	0	1,486,000
DKK	10,980,275	10,980,276
SEK	87,000	5,074,000

		2023
Currency	Purchase	Sale
USD	5,537,000	190,691,517
JPY	62,000,000	1,717,666,000
CAD	0	914,000
EUR	196,229,592	5,425,153
GBP	0	6,405,000
NZD	0	431,000
AUD	0	1,490,000
DKK	0	0
SEK	0	4,917,000

The market price of the forward currency contracts and swaps as of December 31 is set at the value of the securities in question, see notes 12 and 13.

Board and Secretariat



The board

In 2024, the board conducted 5 board meetings and was represented at 27 follow-up meetings with grant holders. The composition of the board as of March 2025 was as follows:



Dorthe Dahl-Jensen (Chair)

Professor, University of Copenhagen

Appointed by the Ministry of Higher Education and Science (01.08.24-31.07.30)



Sirpa Jalkanen

Professor, University of Turku

Nominated by the Independent Research Fund Denmark (01.12.21-30.11.25)



Tore Rem

Professor, University of Oslo

Nominated by the Independent Research Fund Denmark (01.01.24-31.12.27)



Christian S. Jensen (Vice Chair)

Professor, Aalborg University

Appointed by the Ministry of Higher Education and Science (01.12.21-30.11.25)



Janet M. Thornton

Senior Scientist and Director Emeritus at the European Bioinformatics Institute (EBI)

Nominated by the Danish Academy of Technical Sciences (01.12.21-30.11.25)



Dorte Juul Jensen

Professor, Technical University of Denmark

Nominated by Director-Generals' Board of Applied Research Institutes (01.01.24-31.12.27)



Tine Brink Henriksen

Professor, Aarhus University

Nominated by the Independent Research Fund Denmark (01.12.21-30.11.25)



Anna Dreber Almenberg

Professor, Stockholm School of Economics

Nominated by the Royal Danish Academy of Sciences and Letters (01.01.24-31.12.27)



Stefan Hecht

Professor, Humboldt University, Berlin

Appointed by Universities Denmark (01.02.25-31.12.27)

Secretariat

The composition of the secretariat March 2025 was as follows:



Niels Mejlgaard

CEO, professor, Ph.D.

nm@dg.dk



Johanne Juhl Ryø

Senior Adviser, M.Sc.

jj@dg.dk



Mikkel Bruus

Data Analyst, M.Sc.

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Steen Marcus

CFO, M.Sc.

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Lotte Ladegaard Zeuthen

Head of Communication, M.A. and journalist

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Morten Andreasen

Senior Adviser, Ph.D.

ma@dg.dk



Julie Kaae Majker

Secretary, M.A.

dg@dg.dk



Lotte Mathiesen

Chief Accounting Officer

lm@dg.dk



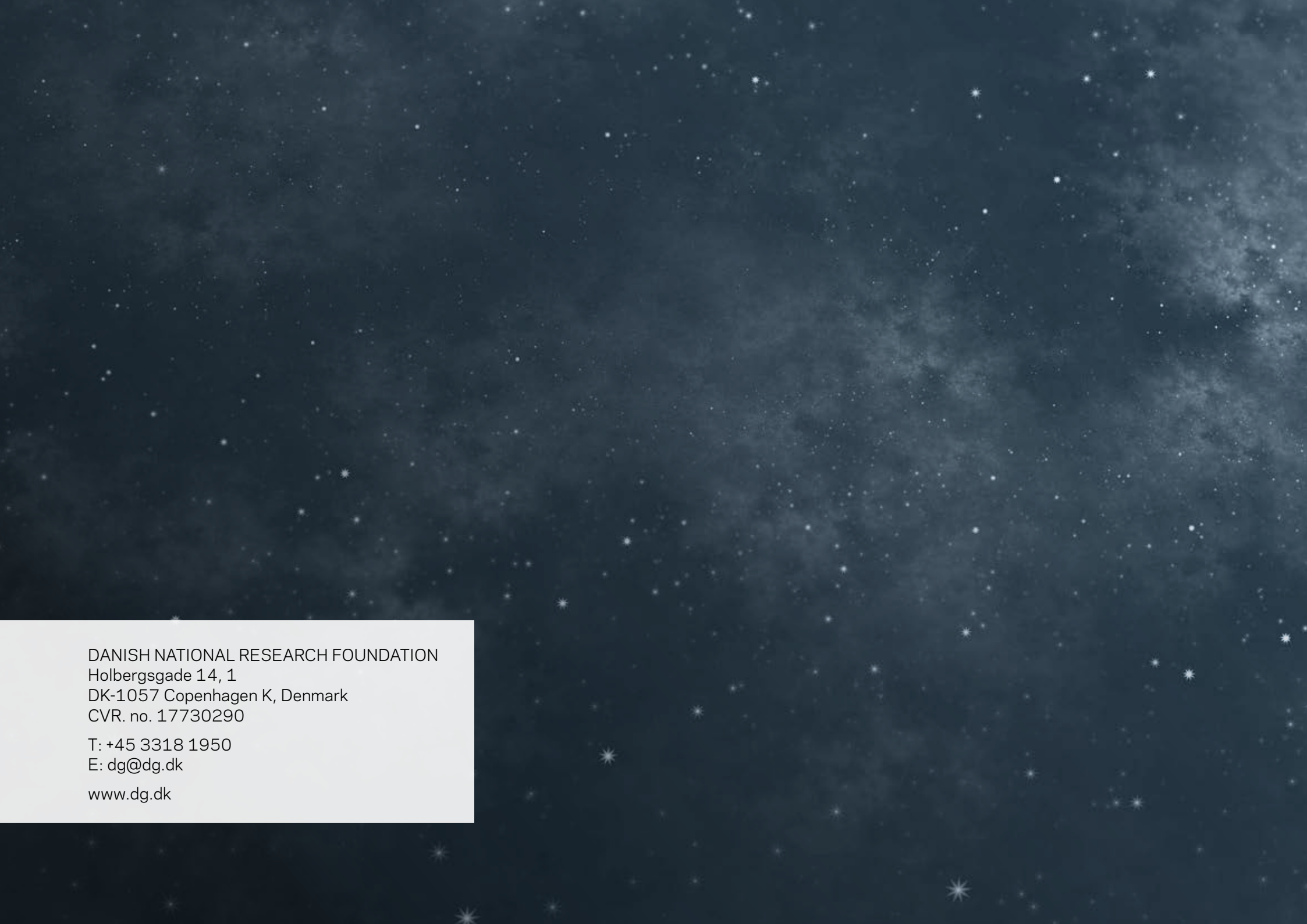
Bao Quoc Truong

Portfolio Manager

bqt@dg.dk

Audit
The Office of the Auditor General and a chartered accountant shall audit the foundation's annual accounts. The board appoints the chartered accountant for a three-year term and the chartered accountant has to be approved by the Minister for Higher Education and Science. Jens Sejer Pedersen (Deloitte), State Authorized Public Accountant, is appointed for the period June 1, 2022, to May 31, 2025.

Editors
Lotte L. Zeuthen
Julie K. Majker
Steen Marcus
Niels Mejlgaard
Dorthe Dahl-Jensen



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